

HEISTY SPIDEYS

A Tabletop Roleplaying Game of Eight-Legged Larceny

For 2–6 players plus one Storyteller who volunteered. Ages 13 and up. The cat will not enjoy this game.





HEISTY SPIDEYS

A Tabletop Roleplaying Game of Eight-Legged Larceny

FIRST EDITION • VERSION 4.5

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EDITING, LAYOUT & ILLUSTRATION

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TYPEFACES

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PLAY IT ONLINE

A companion game system for Foundry Virtual Tabletop:
github.com/PainHog/SpideyHeist

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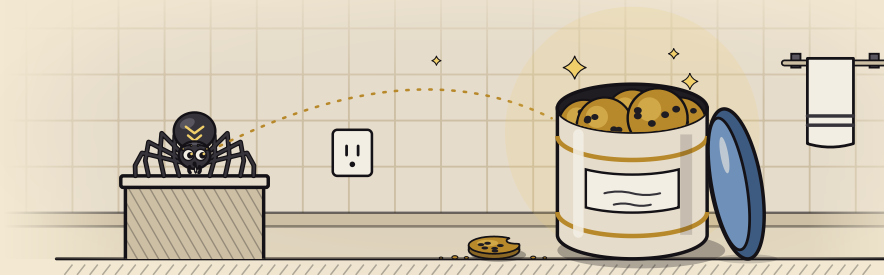
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PART ONE

The Player's Guide





CHAPTER 1

Welcome to Heisty Spideys

It began, as most great crimes do, with opportunity. The cookie tin was unguarded. The human was asleep. The cat was a problem, but the crew had a plan for the cat. The plan did not work. They rarely do. That has never once stopped anyone.

YOU ARE A SPIDER.

You live in the walls of a building owned by creatures ten thousand times your size, who would respond to noticing you with anything from a startled noise to a rolled-up magazine. By any reasonable measure you are small and in danger.

You are also a criminal mastermind.

You have watched the humans for weeks. You know the schedule. You know where the good things are kept. You know the cat naps from two to four, and that the sensor in the hall has a blind spot exactly one spider wide. You have a crew. You have a plan. The plan is held together with silk and optimism, but it is a plan.

Tonight you run it. Something will go wrong — possibly everything. You will succeed anyway, or fail spectacularly, or, most likely, both, in a way the crew will discuss for the rest of your short and eventful careers.

Welcome to Heisty Spideys.

What This Game Is

Heisty Spideys is a tabletop roleplaying game played on a grid. You need a map marked in squares, a token for each spider, dice, and a group of friends willing to commit small crimes as small animals. One of you runs the world. The rest play spiders stealing something out of it.

You can play it on a printed map with tokens and a handful of dice, or on a virtual tabletop — a companion game system for Foundry VTT is being released alongside this

book. Every rule here is built to work the same way in both places: count the squares, move the tokens, roll the dice.

The inspiration is heist stories. *Ocean's Eleven*. *The Italian Job*. *Leverage*. The episode of any show where the team breaks into somewhere fancy and it all goes beautifully wrong. If you have ever watched one of those and thought *I would like to do that, but as a spider*, this book was written for you specifically.

The tone is comedic disaster with real stakes. Things go wrong. The Alert climbs. Someone sneezes at the exact wrong moment. But the chance of actually failing is real, and the tension is what makes the comedy land — a near-miss isn't funny unless there was something to miss.

The Storyteller

One player runs the world. They are the Storyteller, or ST, because writing it out every time is a job.

The Storyteller's job is not to beat the crew. The ST builds a place that is interesting to fail inside — a location with real geography, active threats, a cat with opinions, and at least one thing the crew didn't account for. The ST runs that world honestly and lets it do the work. The world catches spiders on its own. It doesn't need help.

Full guidance is in Part Two. Read Part One first anyway. Knowing what the crew can do makes you a sharper ST.

The Crew

Everyone else plays a spider with a job. Your spider has a **Species** (what kind of spider you are, which grants a passive ability), a **Crew Role** (your function on the job), **Attributes and Skills** (your numbers), a **Speed** (how far you move on the grid), and exactly one **Flaw** that will surface at the worst available time.

No two spiders are alike. The Ghost reaches places nobody else can. The Tinkerer builds tools out of whatever's on the floor. The Face can talk a house cat into looking the other way. The Bruiser cannot, and has stopped trying. The Bruiser has other methods.

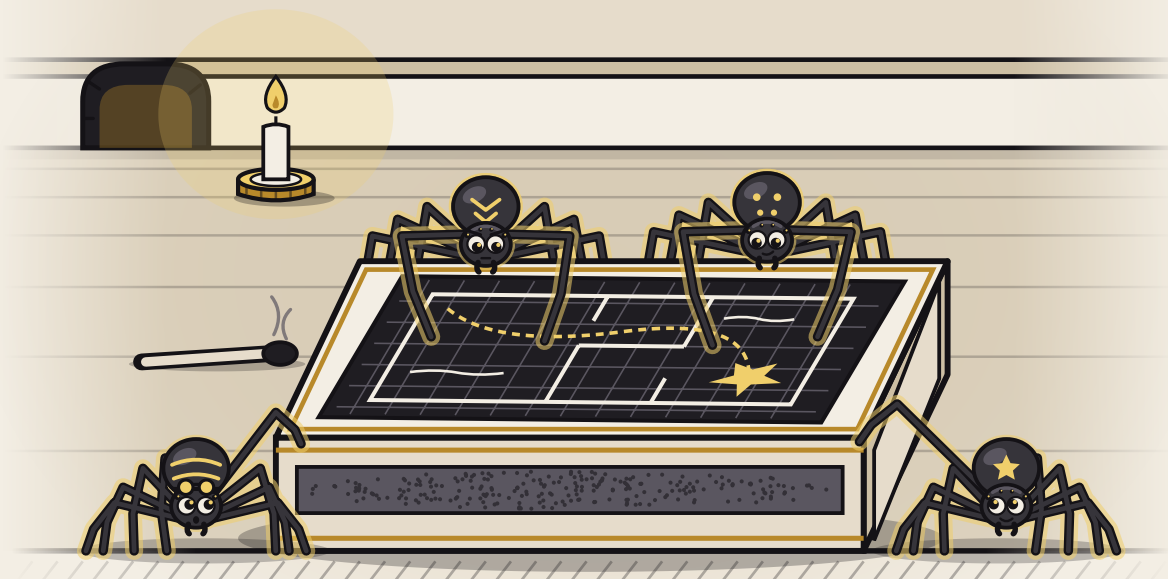
The Waiting Web — Nobody Sits Out

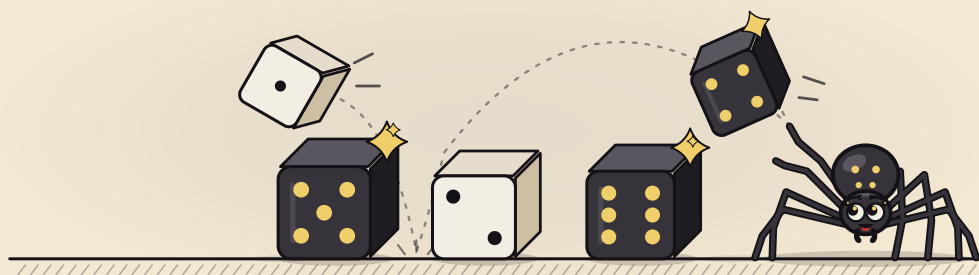
If your spider is caught — jarred, vacuumed, scooped up by a delighted child — you are not out of the game. You draw from the **Waiting Web**: a backup spider who was outside the whole time, got the distress signal, and is on their way in.

Your replacement arrives at the next obstacle, a little worse for having heard what happened to the last one, but in the job. The game doesn't stop for casualties. It barely slows down. The best heist stories don't end when someone gets caught. They get worse, which is better.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 2–6 players, plus one Storyteller.
- A pile of six-sided dice. At least six per player, more is better. Actual play uses only d6s. (The character-creation tables in Chapter 20 use a d10 and a pair of d6s — that's for rolling up a spider, not for the heist.)
- A grid map for each heist — a printed battle map, a dry-erase grid, or a virtual tabletop.
- A token per spider, plus tokens for the cat, the human, and anything else that moves.
- Something to track Silk Points per spider — coins, beads, bits of gravel.
- A shared Alert track everyone can see — a whiteboard number, a row of dice, a line on paper.
- Snacks. Heists take time.





CHAPTER 2

Core Rules — How to Roll Dice

WHEN A SPIDER TRIES SOMETHING UNCERTAIN — A lock, a sleeping cat, convincing a human the scratching in the wall is nothing — you roll dice. Six-sided dice. Only six-sided dice.

The Core Mechanic

Roll a handful of d6s. Every die showing **4, 5, or 6 is a Success**. The Storyteller says how many Successes the task needs. You get them or you don't. That is the entire engine. Everything after this is detail.

THE ONE RULE

Roll your pool of d6s. Count every 4, 5, or 6 as a Success. Get enough and the thing happens. Fall short and it doesn't — and something else goes wrong. The dice do not care about your plan. The dice do not care about anything.

Building Your Dice Pool

Your pool = the relevant **Attribute + Skill**. The ST tells you which apply. Add them, grab that many d6s, roll.

EXAMPLE

Pebbles, a Wolf Spider Bruiser, wants to shove a stuck cabinet door. The ST calls for BODY + Athletics. Pebbles has BODY 4 and Athletics 3, so she rolls 7 dice against a Difficulty 3 door. She rolls five Successes and flings the door open hard enough to bounce it off the wall. She succeeded. The heist may not have. The human is awake now.

Difficulty

DIFFICULTY	SUCCESSES	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE
Trivial	1	Crossing an empty counter. Nothing is happening.
Easy	2	Moving quietly while the TV is on. Picking up a small thing without dropping it.
Moderate	3	Picking a lock. Sneaking past a drowsy cat. Most of a normal heist.
Hard	4	Sneaking past an alert cat. Cracking a password. Surviving the exterminator.
Absurd	5	Stealing a specific item from a locked case while the cat watches and the vacuum is running.

Types of Results

Full Success — it worked. You got enough Successes. The thing happens. Enjoy it. The Alert is still right there.

Partial Success — it worked, but. At least one Success, fewer than needed. You make progress *and* a complication lands. The lock opens, but you made noise. You clear the gap, but you drop the bag. The ST picks the complication — ideally the funniest one that also actually costs you something.

Failure — it did not work. Zero Successes. No progress, and something gets worse. Failure is a beat, not a wall. The door stays shut *and* there's a noise now. Every failure should cost something and reveal something.

Critical Success — you did it perfectly. Double the required Successes (6 on a Difficulty 3, 8 on a Difficulty 4). It works better than planned — you get the item *and* spot a second

way out — and the Alert drops by 1 (only on a roll of Difficulty 2 or higher). This is the only thing that lowers the Alert during a heist. Savor it.

The Botch. Your pool has been reduced to 0 or below — by Vitality penalties, Lockdown, or a situation so bad the ST rules you can barely function (crushed against a surface, total darkness, upside down in a jar). You still roll one die. On a **1–3**, Botch: you fail *and* the Alert jumps by 2. On a **4–6**, a clean failure, no bonus disaster. This time.

A Botch is what happens when the Bruiser attempts subtlety at Stealth 0 while Critical. Once the table recovers, it is very funny.

Assists

Any crew member in the same scene who isn't the one rolling can **Assist**, as their Action, if they can actually reach or help the active spider — usually meaning **adjacent on the grid**, or connected by a silk line, or otherwise plausibly lending a hand. They roll their relevant **Skill only** — no Attribute — to a **maximum of 3 dice**, minimum 1. Each Success adds one die to the active spider's pool. Only one spider can Assist a given roll.

Opposed Rolls

When you act against something that's actively resisting — an alert cat, a suspicious human, a vacuum in pursuit — both sides roll. Most Successes wins. **Ties go to the defender.** When you and the world tie, the world wins; it's bigger than you. (The exception is taking a hit, where *you* are the defender — see Chapter 10.) Assists work normally, but only the spider side can receive one.

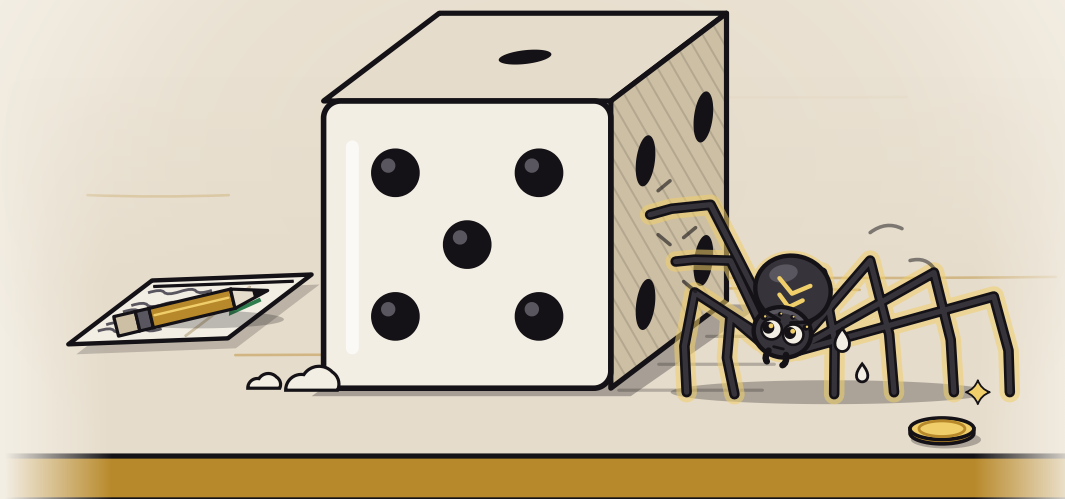
When Not to Roll

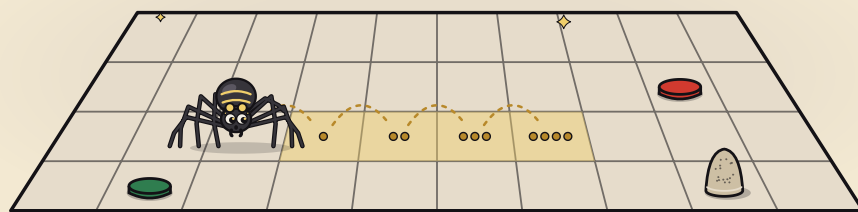
Not everything needs dice. If success is guaranteed, just say yes. A Stealth 4 spider crossing an empty kitchen at 3 a.m. walks across. The same spider crossing while the cat stares directly at it rolls.

Roll when the outcome is uncertain *and* failure would be interesting. If either is false, skip the dice. The story doesn't need a d6's permission to continue.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

The most common table mistake is rolling for everything. Don't. Rolls create tension, and tension is a resource — spend it where failure changes the story. Roll for every footstep and the Alert hits its limit before anyone finds the safe.





CHAPTER 3

The Grid — Tiles, Tokens, and Movement

HEISTY SPIDEYS IS PLAYED ON A SQUARE GRID. EVERY heist location is a map marked in squares; every spider, cat, human, and vacuum is a token that stands on one. When something moves, you move the token and count the squares. This is what keeps a heist honest — everyone can see exactly how far the cat is, exactly how far you have to go, and exactly how bad the timing is.

You can run this on a printed map, a dry-erase grid, or a virtual tabletop. The rules don't change. Count squares, move tokens, roll dice.

One Square = One Spider

A single grid square is about the size of one spider. Your token fills one square. When a rule gives a distance, it's measured in squares.

Distances are never inches or “spider-lengths” — always squares. A reach of “6 squares” is most of the way across a small room, which, to a spider, is a long way.

Speed

Your **Speed** is how many squares you can move on your turn. It's set by your species (Chapter 4). Most spiders have Speed 5. Wolf Spiders run at 7, Jumping Spiders at 6. Crab Spiders, who would rather wait, move 4.

- **Diagonal moves count as one square.** Keep it simple; a step is a step.
- Being **Hurt** cuts your Speed in half (round down). At **Critical** you can't move on your own — an adjacent crewmate can bring you along at half their Speed. See Chapter 10.

Your Turn: Move + One Action

On your turn you may **move up to your Speed** and take **one Action**. You can split your movement — move a few squares, act, move the rest. You don't have to use all of it, or any of it.

An **Action** is the thing you roll for, or a deliberate equivalent: pick a lock, make a Stealth check, shove a door, spit silk, Assist an ally, patch a crewmate, use a Signature Move (unless it says otherwise). You get one per turn.

Free actions don't cost your Action: a quick word to the crew, dropping an item, glancing around. If you're not sure whether something is free, it probably takes your Action.

EXAMPLE TURN

Nook the Ghost is 4 squares from a cracked-open drawer, with the cat's token 6 squares away and asleep. Nook has Speed 5. She moves 4 squares to the drawer (movement), then picks the lock (Action: Engineering). She has one square of movement left but stays put — no reason to walk back into the open.

Adjacency and Reach

The eight squares around you — orthogonal and diagonal — are **adjacent**. Anything you do up close (a Brawl, an Assist, patching a crewmate, grabbing the loot from someone's grip) needs you to be adjacent, unless a rule says otherwise.

Ranged reach — the Spitting Spider's strand, a thrown distraction, a silk grapple — is measured in squares along the shortest path, and needs **line of sight** to the target.

Line of Sight and Cover

Line of sight is a straight line from your square to another that isn't fully blocked by a wall or solid object. You can't spot, target, or be spotted through a wall. This cuts both ways, constantly, and learning to use it is most of playing well.

Cover: if a solid object sits between you and something that might see you — a mug, a book, a table leg — you have cover. **Increase the Difficulty to spot or target you by 2.** A spider that keeps furniture between itself and the cat is a spider the cat has trouble finding.

Climbing, Squeezing, and Rough Ground

You are a spider. The walls and ceiling are yours.

- **Climbing:** moving up a wall or across a ceiling costs normal movement. Spiders climb; that's the whole point of being one.
- **Slick or hostile surfaces:** freshly cleaned glass, a moving appliance, anything actively trying to shed you costs double movement, or an Acrobatics roll if the ST calls for one.
- **Rough ground:** a cluttered or hazard-edged square costs **+1 movement** to enter.
- **Height:** crossing somewhere a fall would really hurt — a curtain rod, a shelf edge over the kitchen floor — adds +1 Difficulty to Acrobatics rolls.

- **Squeezing:** a gap smaller than a square takes an Acrobatics roll (Difficulty 2) to pass. Cellar Spiders ignore this entirely.
- **Occupied squares:** you can't end your turn in a square another creature occupies. You may pass through an ally's square. You may not pass through an enemy's — except a Cellar Spider, who folds around anything.

Turn Order

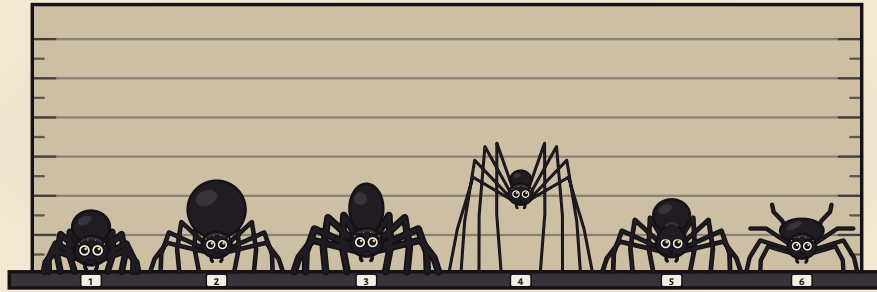
Most of a heist doesn't need turns at all — the crew moves and acts, the ST responds, everyone keeps up. **Turn order only matters when timing is tight:** an active cat, a chase, a room where seconds count.

When it matters, it's simple. **The crew takes its turns first, in whatever order the crew agrees on, then the ST runs the threats.** Repeat until the moment is over. No initiative rolls, no tracking who's on what count. The crew coordinates because coordinating is the fun part; the world answers all at once, because the world is not on the crew's schedule.

STORYTELLER NOTE — KEEP THE MAP HONEST

The grid is a promise: what players can see is true. If the cat is 6 squares away, it is 6 squares away, and a player who counts is allowed to count. Don't fudge distances to manufacture tension — the honest distances are tense enough. When you place a threat, place it where it actually is, and let the crew do the math. Half of this game is a spider staring at a token going *we can make that. Probably. We can probably make that.*





CHAPTER 4

Spider Species

THERE ARE THOUSANDS OF KINDS OF SPIDER. SIX OF them are suited to organized crime. The others have tried. It did not go well, and we will leave it there.

Your species gives you one **passive ability** — something you can do just by being what you are — plus an **Attribute bonus** and a **Speed**. You don't spend Silk Points on your species ability. You don't roll for it. It works.

Jumping Spider



SPECIES ABILITY — “DID YOU SEE THAT JUMP?!”

Once per scene, declare an automatic success on a single leap: cross a gap in a straight line up to your Speed in squares, no roll, landing exactly where you meant to. It does not make you land quietly. That is a separate problem, and it is now yours.

Jumping Spiders are the acrobats of the underworld, and they know it, and they will bring it up. They look like someone glued oversized eyes to a scrap of carpet, which is exactly why humans who spot them say “aww” instead of reaching for a shoe. That reaction lasts about four seconds. Use them well.

Attribute Bonus: BODY +1, GRACE +1 • **Speed:** 6

Orb Weaver



SPECIES ABILITY — “EVERYTHING CONNECTS”

As an Action, spin silk across up to 3 connected squares — a line or a small web. Choose what it is when you spin it:

- **Snare:** the first creature to enter a webbed square is caught. It must spend an Action to break free, or roll Athletics/Brawl against Difficulty 3.
- **Line:** your crew moves along the webbed squares as safe footing — up a wall, across a gap — with no Acrobatics roll.

It lasts until it's broken or the scene ends. Once per scene.

Orb Weavers are architects. They look at a room and see the geometry first and the crime second. Give one a corner and a minute and they will have rigged the space to work for the crew — a tripline here, a bridge there, all of it load-bearing and none of it where the cat is looking.

Attribute Bonus: WIT +2 • **Speed:** 5

Wolf Spider



SPECIES ABILITY — “RUN IT AGAIN”

When you fail or partially succeed on a chase, pursuit, or physical-confrontation roll, immediately reroll all your failed dice and keep the better result. Once per scene. Wolf Spiders do not accept the first result. They would like you to know they don't accept the second one either, but the rules only give them the one reroll.

Wolf Spiders are the muscle — built, fast, and constitutionally opposed to sneaking. They don't spin webs; they chase things down. They shine in the part of every heist where the plan is over and someone needs to run very fast in a useful direction.

Attribute Bonus: BODY +2 · Speed: 7

Cellar Spider



SPECIES ABILITY — “CONTORTIONIST”

You squeeze through any gap a spider could theoretically fit through — no roll, no penalty for tight spaces, ever. You can also fold around a creature in your path: you may move *through* an occupied square, including an enemy's, as long as you don't end your turn there.

Cellar Spiders are long, thin, and aggressively unimpressive, which is a tactical asset. Nobody worries about the faint spindly thing in the corner. Nobody has ever worried about the faint spindly thing in the corner. The faint spindly thing in the corner is already inside the wall the safe is bolted to.

Attribute Bonus: GRACE +2 · Speed: 5

Spitting Spider



SPECIES ABILITY — “PRECISION APPLICATION”

Fire a precise silk-and-venom strand up to **6 squares**, no roll to hit, as long as you have line of sight. Use it to jam a small mechanism (a lock, a sensor, a latch), snag a light object, or pin a small target in place for one round. The range is exactly 6 squares. That is most of a room.

Spitting Spiders are the snipers of the species. They don't rush. They identify a target, work out the line, and fire with the calm of someone who never misses. They have, in fact, missed. They do not discuss it.

Attribute Bonus: WIT +2, NERVE +1 · Speed: 5

Yes, that's a +3 total, one more than everyone else. The trade is range: 6 squares is a real limit, and a Spitting Spider who can't get within 6 is just a spider with excellent posture.

Crab Spider

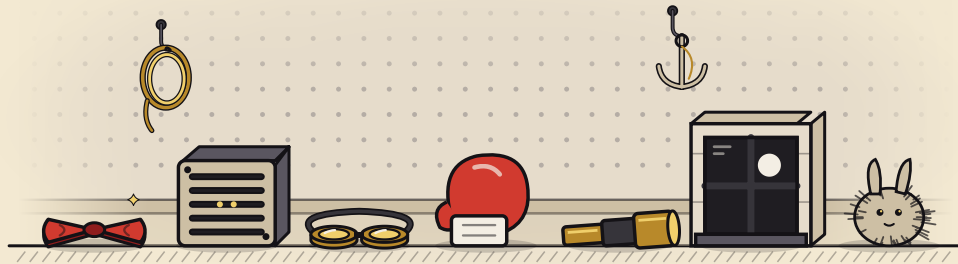


SPECIES ABILITY — “WAIT, WAS THAT THERE BEFORE?”

Hold completely still for one full turn and your coloring shifts to match your surroundings. It's not perfect — you're a spider the color of a countertop — but the Difficulty to spot you increases by 2 until you move. Crab Spiders are excellent at waiting. They are worse at stopping.

Crab Spiders move sideways, which is unsettling before they've done anything, and they hunt by ambush, which makes them the only species with patience built into the body. They hold a position beautifully. They sometimes hold it past the moment they were supposed to act, because they were comfortable.

Attribute Bonus: NERVE +1, GRACE +1 · Speed: 4



CHAPTER 5

Crew Roles

EVERY HEIST CREW RUNS ON SPECIALISTS. **HEISTY** Spideys has seven — fewer than *Ocean's Eleven*, and considerably more legs.

Your Role is your job on the crew. It grants bonus points in your core skills, a **Signature Move** no other Role has, and a list of Perks. You pick **two Perks** at creation.

The Face

“Relax. I’ve got this. No — actually, keep worrying, that part’s fair.”

The Face is the crew’s social specialist. Where others use force or stealth or engineering, the Face uses conversation — with cats, humans, guard spiders, whatever stands between the crew and the door. Charming, quick, and occasionally making things worse in ways that won’t surface until it’s far too late to bring up.



Core Skills: Deception, Persuasion · **Role Bonus:** +3 points split between them.

SIGNATURE MOVE — “THAT’S NOT WHAT HAPPENED”

Once per heist, after any roll — including one the ST made for an NPC — spend 2 Silk Points to reframe what just happened in the crew’s favor. You don’t change the mechanical result; you change the story around it. The cat didn’t spot you — it spotted a bit of fluff. The human didn’t hear a crash — the building settled. Deliver it smoothly, with total confidence. The ST accepts it. If the cat rolled to pounce, the pounce still happens — you’re just explaining why it landed on nothing important. It also cancels any Alert increase that roll would have caused.

PERK	EFFECT
Silver Tongue	When you fail a Persuasion roll, reroll it once. You said it better the second time.
Read the Room	Before a social encounter, ask the ST one thing the NPC actually wants. They answer honestly.
Plausible Deniability	Once per scene, when the crew does something that would raise the Alert by 1, talk that single point away. Stops a +1 only — never a +2 or higher. Not an undo button for the loud mistakes.
Fast Talk	Distract any NPC as a free action, no roll, once per scene. It holds for exactly one round.
Actually, I Planned This	Once per heist, after a plan visibly falls apart, declare it was the plan. The crew gets +1 die on their next roll as everyone commits to the lie.
Familiar Face	You’ve been here before. You know one true detail about the target or location that wasn’t in the briefing.

The Ghost

“I was never here. That shadow wasn’t moving. Go back to sleep.”

The Ghost lives in the spaces between spaces — vents, wall gaps, the three squares behind the fridge nobody has cleaned since 2018. Where others work around security, the Ghost simply isn’t there when it looks.



Core Skills: Stealth, Acrobatics · **Role Bonus:** +3 points split between them.

SIGNATURE MOVE — “PHASE THROUGH”

Once per scene, move through any space a spider could theoretically fit — a crack, a pipe, the gap under a door — no roll, no Alert increase, regardless of the current Alert Level. You arrive on the far side the same turn. Use it to get into a room, out of a room, or, in one documented case, away from a cat so fast the cat sat down and pretended it had never cared.

PERK	EFFECT
Silk Trail	Leave a near-invisible line anywhere you’ve been. Crew can follow it or ride it as a zip line. Holds two spiders.
Dead Drop	Stash a small item anywhere during Planning, no roll. You know exactly where it is. Nobody else does.
Soundless	Reduce the Difficulty of Stealth rolls made while moving by 1. You don’t make noise. You make a point of it.
Second-Story Spider	Climb any surface at full Speed with no roll — even slick or hostile ones that would cost other spiders double or a check.
Ghost Protocol	When you’re the one spotted, immediately make a free Stealth roll to vanish again before the NPC reacts.
I Was Never Here	Increase the Difficulty for any NPC to remember seeing you by 2. You are deeply, fundamentally forgettable.

The Tinkerer

“I can build that. I need a paperclip, some lint, and forty minutes. ... Thirty. Give me thirty.”



The Tinkerer is the crew’s engineer, gadget-maker, and lock-cracker, and the reason there’s always something strange in the bag. They build tools out of what’s lying around, and the tools work about as often as tools made of lint and crumbs should — which is more often than you’d think.

Core Skills: Engineering, Perception • **Role Bonus:** +3 points split between them.

SIGNATURE MOVE — “I MADE A THING”

Once per scene, as your Action, cobble a one-use gadget out of materials at hand — anything plausibly on the map. Pick one effect:

- **Bypass:** defeat one small mechanical obstacle within reach — jam a sensor, pop a simple latch, wedge a drawer — no roll.
- **Boost:** hand it to a crewmate for +2 dice on their next roll.
- **Distraction:** set it off in a target square within 6, pulling every nearby NPC’s attention there for one round.

The ST can veto materials that clearly aren’t available. When in doubt, they’ll ask what you’re building it out of.

PERK	EFFECT
Jury-Rig	Once per scene, fix, jam, or modify a small mechanical device with a Difficulty 2 Engineering roll. Locks, sensors, that one drawer.
Spider-Sense... Sort Of	Spend a turn observing an area and the ST tells you whether any mechanical traps, alarms, or sensors are present — not where.
Overclock	Spend 1 Silk Point for +2 dice on an Engineering roll. It just takes more legs than usual.
Field Repair	Once per scene, patch an adjacent crewmate’s Vitality up one level with a Difficulty 2 Engineering roll. You’re an engineer, not a doctor. Close enough.
Trap Architect	During Planning, set one web-based trap on the known map. When an NPC triggers it, the ST rolls Difficulty 3 for them to avoid it.
I See How This Works	The first time you meet any new lock, alarm, or mechanism, ask the ST one yes/no question about how it works. Free. Just by looking.

The Bruiser

“The plan was to be quiet. That was before the plan involved the cat.”



The Bruiser solves problems physically — not for lack of other options, but because most problems, given enough spider at enough speed, resolve. First responder for anything involving direct confrontation, sudden escalation, or hauling something too heavy for everyone else.

Core Skills: Brawl, Endurance • **Role Bonus:** +3 points split between them.

SIGNATURE MOVE — “MAKE A SCENE”

When the Bruiser causes or joins a significant physical commotion, they may pull every NPC in the scene onto themselves for one full round. This costs nothing — it’s simply what just happened. During that round, every other crew member in the scene gets +2 dice on any roll. Afterward, the entire room is looking very hard at the Bruiser, and the Alert goes up by 1. Once per scene. Worth it? Almost always.

PERK	EFFECT
Take the Hit	Once per scene, redirect a physical consequence meant for an adjacent crewmate to yourself. You chose this.
Unfazed	Ignore the –1 die penalty from being Rattled. You’ve been Rattled before. You’re fine.
Thunderous Entrance	Enter a scene from an unexpected direction and every NPC must pass a Difficulty 3 check or freeze in surprise for a round. Once per scene.
Negotiating Position	Your presence helps. The Face gets +1 die on Persuasion while you’re visibly nearby.
Silk Grapple	Fire a silk line to grab and restrain a target up to 3 squares away — Brawl, Difficulty 3. Small targets held one round.
That All You Got?	After a hit that would drop you to Critical, roll BODY + Endurance (Difficulty 3). On a success, you stop at Hurt instead.

The Lookout

“Cat at two o’clock. Human moving. Vacuum — the vacuum is doing the thing again.”



The Lookout is the crew’s eyes. They track every moving piece — patrol lines, human habits, the cat’s mood, where the vacuum is in its route — and relay it in real time. A good Lookout means nobody is surprised. A bad one means everybody is surprised at once, which is at least fair.

Core Skills: Perception, Tactics · **Role Bonus:** +3 points split between them.

SIGNATURE MOVE — “I CALLED IT”

Once per heist, before any roll, declare you predicted exactly this during your surveillance, and say in one sentence what tipped you off. If it’s remotely plausible, whoever makes that roll gets +1 die. If it’s genuinely plausible and fits what’s been established, +2 instead. If it contradicts known facts, you get nothing, and the ST is allowed to look at you for a while.

PERK	EFFECT
Early Warning	At the start of each obstacle, the ST tells you which direction any active threat moves next. No roll.
Tactical Feed	Once per round, give a crewmate +1 die on their next roll by telling them exactly what to do. You’re not helping. You’re instructing. It’s a free action and doesn’t count as the roll’s Assist.
Pattern Recognition	After watching a patrol or recurring threat for one full round, you know its next three actions.
Contingency	Once per heist during Planning, set one Contingency with the ST. If a specific trigger happens, it activates automatically as a success.
Escape Routes	You always know the fastest way out of a room you’ve been in. Reduce the Difficulty of escape rolls by 1 while you lead.
Counter-Surveillance	Detect when an NPC is watching a specific area — Perception, Difficulty 2. On a success, the ST tells you what’s watched and from where.

The Wheelman

“The exit is that way. It was always that way. We practiced this. WHY ARE YOU GOING THAT WAY.”



The Wheelman runs the getaway. They know every exit, the fastest line to the outside, and how to get eight legs through a closing window in under two seconds. The most important spider on the crew for the last five minutes of any job — which is also when everything is on fire.

Core Skills: Acrobatics, Tactics · **Role Bonus:** +3 points split between them.

SIGNATURE MOVE — “I KNOW A WAY”

Once per heist, during the Escape only, declare a route nobody knew existed — a gap behind the washing machine, a vent straight to the outside, a window that’s mysteriously always cracked. Describe it; the crew can use it. It reduces the Difficulty of every Escape roll by 1 for the whole crew. The route has to be physically possible for spiders.

PERK	EFFECT
Always a Way Out	You can’t be fully cornered. Even when the ST would logically have you trapped, you have one option left. It may be unpleasant.
Shortcut	During Planning, establish one shortcut between two points on the known map. The crew can use it once.
Don’t Look Down	Remove the penalty from height-based Acrobatics rolls. You’ve looked down. You’ve made your peace.
Passenger	Carry one incapacitated crewmate at full Speed. It looks extremely dramatic.
Drafting	When you lead group movement, each crewmate gets +1 die on movement rolls. You set the pace; they follow.
Abort, Abort	Once per heist, call an immediate abort on a failed plan. The crew retreats without the extra Alert that failure would have added.

The Grifter

“I am not a spider. I am a dust bunny. Please don’t look directly at me.”

The Grifter works through identity and misdirection. Where the Face talks through a situation, the Grifter changes what the situation looks like — disguises,



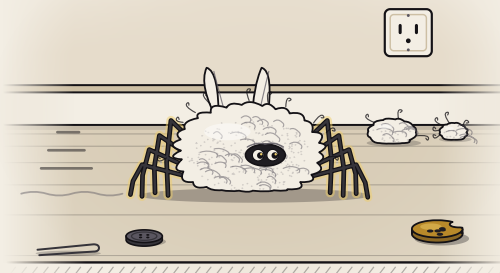
false trails, planted information. They shape what everyone else thinks is happening, which is usually unrelated to what’s happening. On purpose.

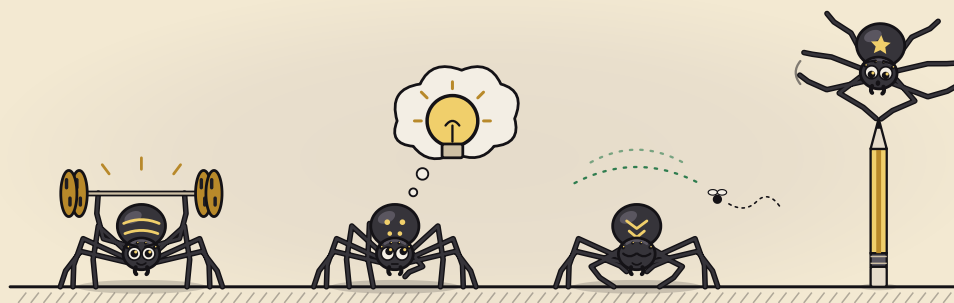
Core Skills: Deception, Disguise · **Role Bonus:** +3 points split between them.

SIGNATURE MOVE — “YOU’RE LOOKING AT THE WRONG SPIDER”

Once per heist, stage a Decoy — a fake version of what the crew is doing, somewhere NPCs can see it. Describe it, and every NPC in the location goes to investigate it for two full rounds, unless they pass a Difficulty 3 Perception roll. For those two rounds the real crew works unobserved, and every roll that’s part of the actual job gets +1 die.

PERK	EFFECT
Method Actor	Choose one NPC before the heist; you’ve studied them. +2 dice on all Deception and Disguise involving that NPC.
Double Bluff	When an NPC sees through your disguise, reveal the disguise <i>was</i> the distraction. Spend 1 Silk Point; the NPC is confused for a round.
Planted Evidence	During Planning, place one false piece of information on the known map. The first NPC to find it believes it completely.
Quick Change	Alter your disguise between scenes with no roll. You look different now. You are still a spider.
The Long Con	Spend Planning establishing a false identity and all rolls using it get +1 die. The identity must be specific and named.
Smoke and Mirrors	When you fail a Deception roll, reframe the failure as intentional. The NPC still isn’t fooled, but they don’t raise the Alert.





CHAPTER 6

Attributes & Skills

YOUR SPIDER HAS FOUR **ATTRIBUTES** AND TWELVE **Skills**. When you roll, you add the relevant Attribute to the relevant Skill. That is the whole of the math.

The Four Attributes

ATTRIBUTE	WHAT IT COVERS
BODY	Physical power and toughness. Brawling, sprinting, absorbing hits, carrying things that are technically too heavy.
WIT	Intelligence and observation. Engineering, spotting what others miss, tactics, planning.

ATTRIBUTE	WHAT IT COVERS
NERVE	Composure and social confidence, including lying to a cat. Stealth, deception, intimidation.
GRACE	Agility and dexterity. Acrobatics, disguise, persuasion. (Persuasion is GRACE because charm is physical.)

The Twelve Skills

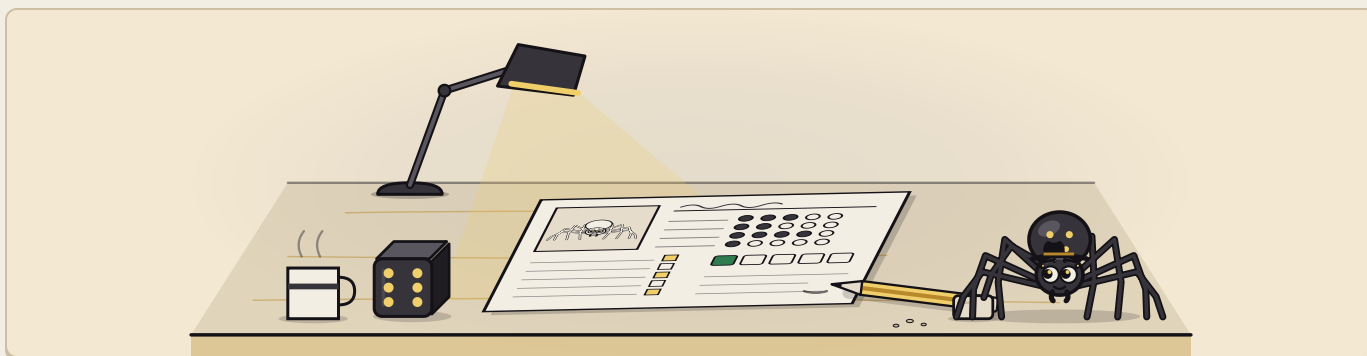
Skills run 0–5. A 0 means you’ve never really tried. A 5 means that, for a spider, you’re world-class.

SKILL	ATTRIBUTE	COVERS	EXAMPLES
Athletics	BODY	Running, climbing, jumping, hauling.	Sprinting a counter, carrying the loot bag
Brawl	BODY	Fighting, grappling, applying spider to problem.	Handling the cat up close, breaking something small
Endurance	BODY	Taking hits, staying up, working hurt.	Absorbing a hit, pushing on while Hurt
Engineering	WIT	Building, breaking, fixing, understanding mechanisms.	Picking locks, building gadgets, jamming sensors
Perception	WIT	Noticing things, reading a room, spotting danger.	Finding a patrol, spotting an ambush, casing a location
Tactics	WIT	Planning, coordinating, thinking ahead.	Directing the crew, finding the route, escape planning
Stealth	NERVE	Moving silently, staying unseen.	Sneaking past the cat, crossing a lit room
Deception	NERVE	Lying, misdirecting, holding a story under pressure.	Convincing a human the noise was nothing, bluffing NPCs
Intimidation	NERVE	Making things afraid of you. Yes, as a spider.	Spooking a smaller creature, making a human hesitate
Acrobatics	GRACE	Precision movement, tumbling, tight spaces.	Swinging on silk, crossing a gap, threading a squeeze
Persuasion	GRACE	Winning people over with charm.	Talking a cat into a nap, negotiating with another spider
Disguise	GRACE	Altering appearance, performing false identities.	Playing a dust bunny, hiding in plain sight

Skill Ratings

RATING	MEANING
0 — Untrained	Never really done it. Your pool is just the Attribute. Hope it's high.
1 — Dabbler	Tried it a few times. Rough idea.
2 — Competent	Reliable under normal circumstances. The cat being normal circumstances.
3 — Skilled	This is your thing. People call on you for it.
4 — Expert	One of the best in the building. Maybe the block.
5 — Legendary	Maximum spider. When you fail at this, it's the dice's fault.





CHAPTER 7

Building Your Spider

C HARACTER CREATION TAKES ABOUT TEN MINUTES. SIX if you've done it before. Forty-five if the table gets into an argument about which species is best. Do the steps in order. Random tables for every step are in Chapter 20 if you'd rather let fate decide.

Step 1 — Choose Your Species

Pick one from Chapter 4. This gives you a passive ability, an Attribute bonus, and your Speed. Some species pair naturally with certain Roles — a Wolf Spider Bruiser, an Orb Weaver Tinkerer — but there are no wrong picks. Play the spider that interests you. The crew wants variety, not optimization.

Step 2 — Choose Your Role

Pick one from Chapter 5. This sets your job, your Signature Move, and your bonus skill points.

Step 3 — Distribute Attributes

You have **10 points** to spread across BODY, WIT, NERVE, and GRACE. **Minimum 1 in each. No Attribute may exceed 5, including your species bonus.** Spend your points, add your species bonus, done.

A 1 in an Attribute is a real limitation — a BODY 1 spider struggles with physical work and getting away — and that's fine. A Tinkerer can't outrun a cat; that's what the Wheelman is for. Build your spider knowing their gaps, and build the crew to cover them.

EXAMPLE SPREAD

Filament is a Jumping Spider Ghost. She assigns BODY 2, WIT 2, NERVE 3, GRACE 3 (10 points). Her Jumping Spider bonus adds +1 BODY and +1 GRACE, for final stats BODY 3, WIT 2, NERVE 3, GRACE 4. Quiet, quick, and slippery, with enough BODY to make the jump she'll absolutely mention afterward.

Step 4 — Note Your Speed

Your Speed comes from your species (Chapter 4): most spiders 5, Wolf Spiders 7, Jumping Spiders 6, Crab Spiders 4. Write it on your sheet. It's how many squares you move on your turn.

Step 5 — Distribute Skills

You have **12 points** for Skills. **Maximum 3 in any one Skill at creation** — this cap includes your Role bonus points. Your Role adds **3 more points** that must go on your two core skills, and can't push either above 3.

You don't need points in everything. Gaps are the reason the crew needs each other. Overlap is fine too — two spiders with Tactics means the plan survives one of you ending up in a jar.

Step 6 — Choose 2 Perks

Pick two from your Role's Perk list. These are what make your spider different from every other spider of the same Role. Choose by playstyle, by what the crew is missing, and by which description made you laugh.

Step 7 — Choose Your Flaw

Take exactly **one Flaw** — either choose one from the list, or roll 1d10 for a random one. One flaw, either way. It's a real constraint, and it will come up.

When your Flaw causes a genuine problem for the crew, you earn **1 Silk Point**. If a Flaw would fire at a truly catastrophic moment — stacking with Lockdown penalties and a failed roll all at once — any spider may spend 1 SP to push it back one round. The Flaw still fires. You just get one beat to breathe.

#	FLAW	EFFECT
1	Arachnophobe Magnet	Humans notice you more than other spiders. The Difficulty to be spotted by humans is reduced by 1 at all times.
2	Overconfident	Once per heist, the ST may make you volunteer for something you shouldn't have, because you said you could handle it. Spend 1 SP to delay it a round — you still do it.
3	Loud	Operationally loud. At Alert 5+, all your Stealth rolls have their Difficulty increased by 1.
4	Dramatic	You cannot simply do a thing. Once per heist, the ST may require your action to involve unnecessary spectacle, raising the Alert by 1. Spend 1 SP to delay one round; it still fires.
5	Allergic to Dust	You'll sneeze at a bad moment at least once per heist — the ST picks when. When you do, make a Stealth roll (Difficulty 3) or the Alert rises by 1. Either way, everyone in earshot knows something happened.
6	Compulsive Planner	Once per heist, the ST may freeze your action for a round while you insist on revising the plan. If the crew acts anyway during that round, you lose 1 SP from the stress. Spend 1 SP to delay the trigger a round — the freeze still happens.
7	Butterfingers	Once per heist, at a moment of the ST's choosing while you're holding an item or the loot, you lose your grip. It lands in a random adjacent square. Someone must use an Action to recover it before moving on. You earn 1 SP for the trouble.

#	FLAW	EFFECT
8	Fear of Vacuums	Vacuums cause immediate panic. When one activates in your scene, make a NERVE roll (Difficulty 3) or lose your action.
9	Easily Distracted	Shiny objects, interesting smells, and fascinating details derail you. Once per heist, the ST can delay your action by one round.
10	Show-Off	Once per heist, the ST may require the Difficulty 4 version of a roll instead of the standard, because you chose the flashier approach. On a Critical, earn 1 SP — the crowd appreciated it. Spend 1 SP to delay the trigger one round.

Step 8 — Calculate Starting Silk Points

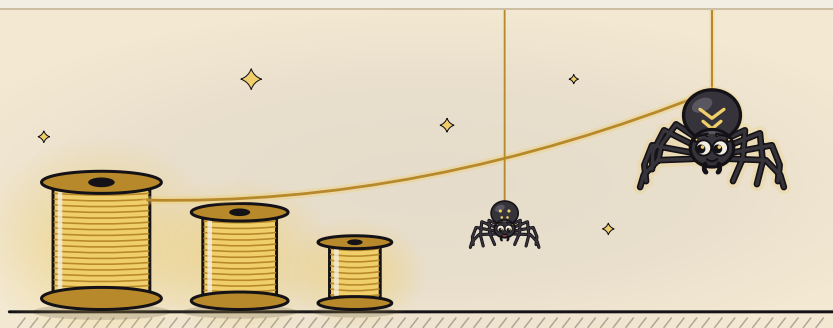
Your starting **Silk Points** = **WIT + NERVE** (after species bonuses). Write it down. It's your most important resource, and you will spend it unwisely. Everyone does.

Step 9 — Name Your Spider

Spider names tend toward objects they've been near (Pebbles, Dusty, Jar Lid), things humans call them (Bathroom Spider, The One in the Corner), plain titles (Eight-Legs, The Boss), or names significantly more dramatic than the spider has earned (Shadowfang, Lord of the Upper Shelf). There's a name table in Chapter 20. One of the entries is just "Gerald." You are allowed to be Gerald.

CHARACTER SHEET CHECKLIST

- Species (with passive ability noted)
- Role (with Signature Move noted)
- Attributes: BODY, WIT, NERVE, GRACE (including species bonuses)
- Speed (from species)
- Skills (12 points + 3 Role bonus; max 3 per skill at creation)
- 2 Perks
- 1 Flaw
- Starting Silk Points (WIT + NERVE)
- Vitality track (starts Unharmed)
- Name



CHAPTER 8

Silk Points

SILK POINTS ARE THE ECONOMY OF THE HEIST. THEY REPRESENT YOUR SPIDER'S PREPARATION, FOCUS, AND THE SPECIFIC desperate improvisation that only happens when you're three squares from the prize and the vacuum just switched on.

You start with **WIT + NERVE** Silk Points. When they're gone, they're gone — there's no mid-heist refill. There's only spending well, earning a few back through spectacular failure, and rationing the rest.

Spending Silk Points

COST	EFFECT
1 SP — Extra Die	Add 1 die to a roll before it's made. The most common spend, and a good one.
1 SP — Silk Line	Instantly run a silk line between two points up to 5 squares apart, for climbing, swinging, or rigging. No roll.
2 SP — Reroll	After rolling, reroll up to 3 dice and keep the better result. For when the dice have wronged you personally.
2 SP — Web Structure	Build a small web structure with no roll — a net, a tripwire, a platform, a hammock. The hammock has no tactical use. The Tinkerer built it anyway.
2 SP — Improvise	Swap the called-for Skill for one of yours that could plausibly work — Engineering to rig a hoist instead of Athletics to climb, Deception instead of Stealth — at +1 Difficulty. A last resort for working outside your specialty.
3 SP — Silk Clutch	After a failed roll, spend 3 SP to succeed anyway. The Alert rises by 1. You did it, at a cost.
3 SP — Damage Control	The crew spends 3 SP together to reduce one Alert spike of +2 or more by 1. Once per heist. Call it the moment the spike triggers, before it's added.
4 SP — Not Part of the Plan	Negate one complication the ST just introduced — used immediately, before consequences resolve. Once per heist. The complication doesn't happen. You explain later how you accounted for it. You didn't.

Earning Silk Points

REWARD	WHEN
+1 SP — Flaw Moment	Your Flaw causes a genuine problem the crew has to deal with.
+1 SP — Spectacular Failure	You fail in a way that genuinely makes the table laugh. ST's call.
+1 SP — Creative Species Use	You use your species ability in a way nobody saw coming, and it works.
+2 SP — Brilliant Plan	You describe a plan that makes the whole table lean in and say "oh, that's good," and the ST agrees.

SILK POINT MANAGEMENT

The classic mistake is spending Silk Points early on small problems and having none when the Alert is at 7 and the cat has found the bag. Start conservative; spend big when it matters. Your strategy should shift as the Alert climbs: early on, hoard — small failures aren't worth big spends. As the Alert nears its limit, switch to preventing failures rather than recovering from them. A 1 SP die *before* a roll at Alert 6 is worth more than a 3 SP Silk Clutch *after* a roll at Alert 8.



CHAPTER 9

The Alert

THE **ALERT** IS A SINGLE NUMBER THAT TRACKS HOW awake the location is. It starts at **0** and climbs toward a **Limit** the Storyteller sets before the heist. When it reaches the Limit, the place goes to Full Alert: the objective is lost, and the only goal left is getting out with your legs attached.

The Alert only goes up during a heist. The one exception is a Critical Success, which drops it by 1 (only on a roll of Difficulty 2 or higher). Everything else is upward pressure. Plan accordingly.

The Alert is the location's overall state of alertness, not any one creature's senses. When Stealth gets harder at Alert 3, the cat didn't suddenly grow better ears — the cat is awake and moving, covering ground it wasn't before. Higher Alert means more things are active, in more places. The fiction justifies the number; the number just keeps score.

The Alert Limit

LOCATION	LIMIT	DESCRIPTION
Easy	10	A mostly empty house. Light traffic. One cat, and it's elderly.
Standard	8	Occupied home with pets. A small office. A restaurant after hours.
Hard	6	An active office. A pet store with several animals. A library with an attentive librarian.
Absurd	4	Anywhere with a cat <i>and</i> a dog <i>and</i> a human who sleeps lightly.
Legendary	2	So locked down it's barely worth it. Active guards, several independent threats, a professionally suspicious human. The job pays 8 AP. That's why.

The examples are typical, not fixed — the same kind of place can be easier or harder. A pet store at night with its animals caged is Standard; the same store with animals loose is Hard.

What Raises the Alert

AMOUNT	TRIGGER
+1	A roll fails with a consequence — noise, attention, evidence.
+1	Spotted briefly — an NPC notices something's off but isn't sure.
+1	A Silk Clutch is used. The universe keeps score.
+2	A Botch. Everything that could go wrong did, plus one new thing.
+2	A confirmed alert — an NPC knows something is happening, even if not what.
+2	A spider goes Out. The location notices something is very wrong.
+2	A Loud Failure — something loud breaks, a crash that carries across the location.
+X	A creature's own contribution each round it's active (see its stat block). A creature is <i>active</i> when its Escalation says it's awake, hunting or pursuing.

Alert Thresholds

LEVEL	WHAT HAPPENS
0–2 — Calm	The plan is working. Enjoy it. It won't last.
3–4 — Stirring	Something feels off. Stealth rolls have their Difficulty increased by 1.
5–6 — Active	A threat has woken up — the cat is on its feet, a human checked the kitchen, the vacuum changed its route. No roll penalty yet.
7+ — Lockdown	Everything is wrong. All rolls have their Difficulty increased by 1. Multiple NPCs are active.
At Limit — Full Alert	The location is compromised. If the crew doesn't have the objective yet, it's out of reach. Escape is the only play, and it will be memorable. If they do have it, they just need to get out.

At a Limit of 6 or less, the location hits Full Alert before Lockdown — lower Limits skip the later bands entirely. That's what makes them hard.

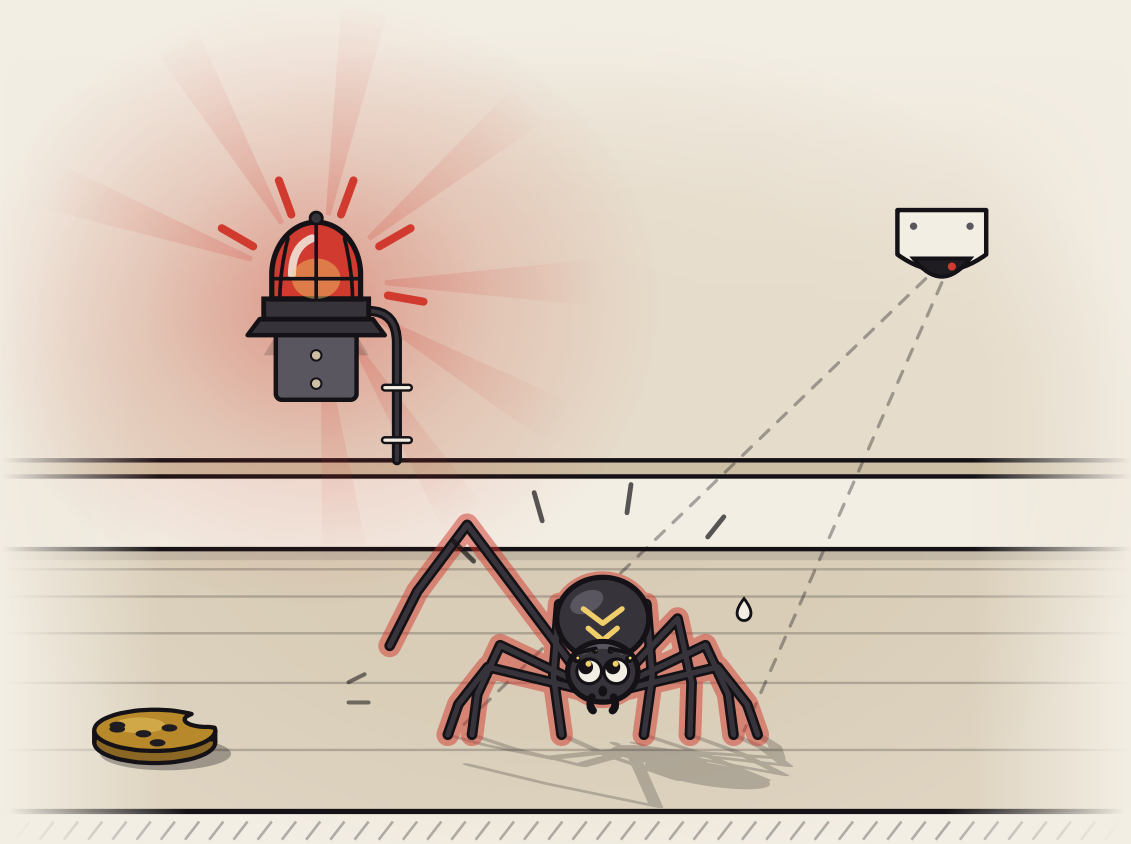


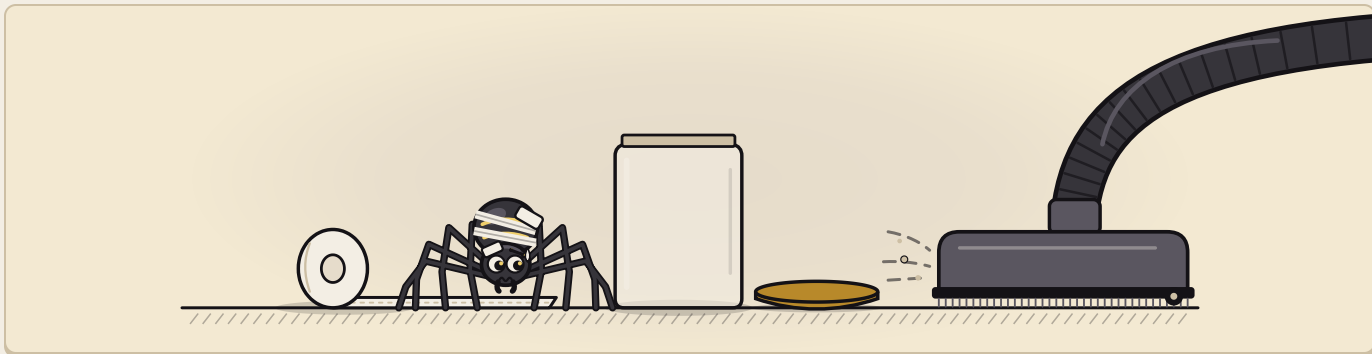
STORYTELLER NOTE — TWO THRESHOLDS PEOPLE CONFUSE

Penalties stack. At Alert 7+, Stealth is +2 Difficulty total (the Stirring penalty and the Lockdown penalty both apply). Track them separately so the crew always knows what they're facing.

The critical distinction: **Active (5–6) turns threats on — it does not raise Difficulty.** The cat wakes; the human stirs; nothing gets mechanically harder to roll yet. **Only Lockdown (7+) raises Difficulty.** This is the single most misread rule in the game. Active means something is now moving. Lockdown means everything is now harder.

The Alert should feel like pressure, not punishment. At 3, foreshadow — a creak, one open eye. At 5, escalate — make something active and specific. At 7, hard but survivable. At the Limit, the heist is over but the escape is its own story. Never just say “the Alert hit 8, you lose.” Make the lockdown land.





CHAPTER 10

Vitality

SPIDERS GET HURT. THEY'RE SWATTED, STARTLED OFF ledges, trapped in jars, and occasionally inhaled by a vacuum nobody planned for. Vitality tracks how much your spider can take before they're **Out**.

The Vitality Track

STATE	EFFECT
Unharmed	Full capabilities. The cat hasn't found you.
Rattled (-1 die)	Shaken, bruised, or briefly jarred. -1 die on all rolls.
Hurt (-2 dice, half Speed)	Bad. You're limping. -2 dice on everything, and your Speed is halved (round down).
Critical (-3 dice, must be assisted)	You can't move effectively under your own power — a crewmate must help you move. You can still act, barely. -3 dice.
Out	Caught. Jarred, vacuumed, or adopted. Out of this heist. Activate the Waiting Web.



Taking Hits

When a threat lands a hit on you — a pounce, a swat, a snapping beak — you **drop one Vitality level**, unless you can shrug it off.

To shrug it off, roll **BODY + Endurance** against the threat's attack. Compare Successes:

- **You meet or beat the attack's Successes** — you shrug it off. No level lost.
- **The attack beats you by 1 or 2** — drop one level.

- **The attack beats you by 3 or more** — drop two levels. That one landed.

You're the defender here, so ties go to **you**. BODY and Endurance help, but they don't make you untouchable — a solid hit from a real threat will get through more often than not, which is the point. Getting hit should cost something.

Not every contact is a full hit. A glancing bump or a bit of flying debris might be a flat **-1 die for one round** instead of a Vitality check — the ST calibrates. Reserve full checks for genuine impacts: a direct swat, a fall, a pounce that connects. Rough guide: **if a human would notice it happening, it's a hit. If they wouldn't, it's a distraction at most.**

Some hits skip the roll. When a book falls on you or a child's hand closes around you, the ST will just tell you it landed. You drop a level — or go straight to Out — and the story moves.

Recovery

Spend a full round with **no threat able to reach or target you** — or the quiet gap between obstacles — and you recover one level, once per obstacle. Recovery is passive — surviving a quiet turn is enough; you don't have to spend your Action on it.

A Tinkerer with the Field Repair Perk can also patch you actively: **Engineering, Difficulty 2, as their Action, while adjacent** — one level recovered on a success, threats present or not.

Recovery means actually stopping. "I'll heal while running" is not a thing.

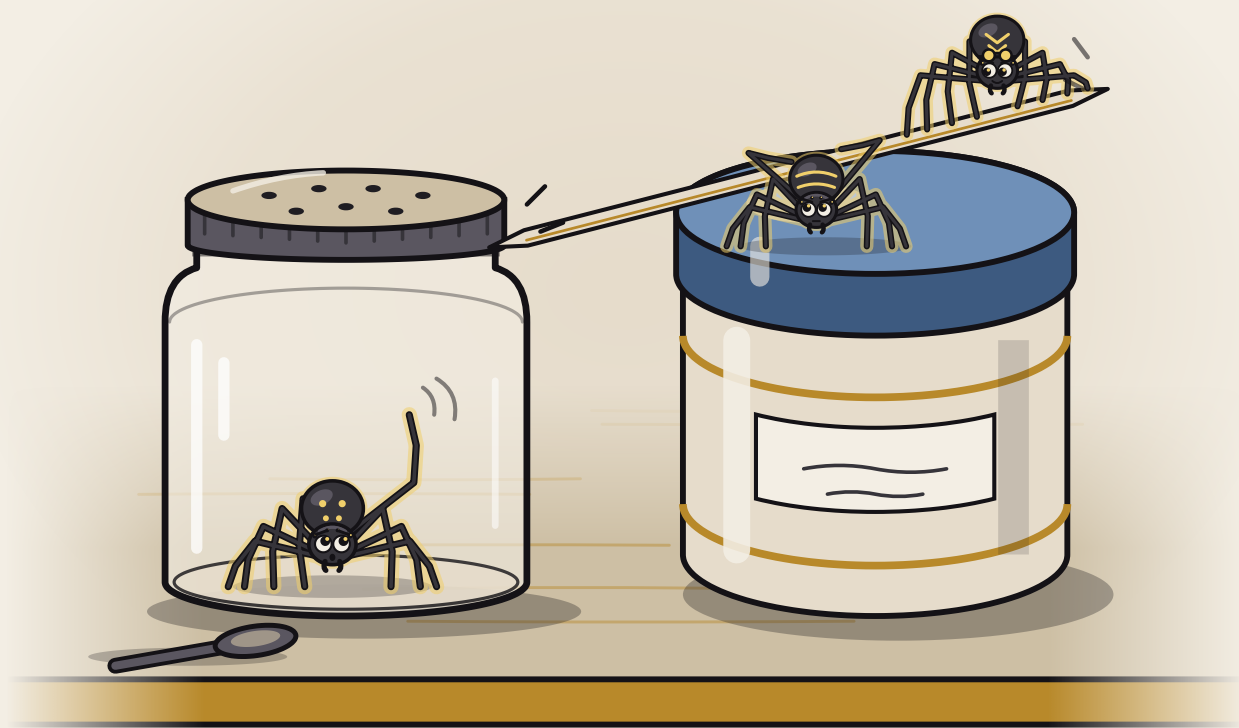
Going Out — Activating the Waiting Web

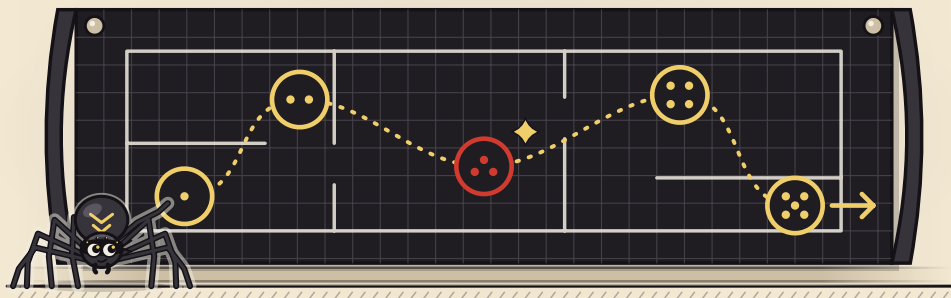
When a spider goes Out, two things happen at once:

First: the Alert rises by 2. The location noticed.

Second: the player draws a fresh spider from the Waiting Web. Same Role, Attributes, Skills, and Perks as the original — this is backup crew built for the job, not a stranger

wandering in. Change the name, and optionally the species — if you do, swap the old species' Attribute bonus and Speed for the new one's (no Attribute above 5). The replacement keeps the Flaw. They enter at the start of the next obstacle, starting **Rattled** (not Unharmed) with **half their starting Silk Points, rounded down**. They heard it was bad in there. They came anyway.





CHAPTER 11

The Heist Structure

A HEIST RUNS IN FIVE PHASES: THE BRIEFING, THE plan, the job, the scramble, and the debrief where everyone agrees it went fine and no one mentions the cat.

Phase 1 — The Score

The Storyteller presents the job. What's the target, where is it, what's the location? The ST lays out the **map** — the grid the crew will be working on — and describes what a spider can actually see from the entry point: the geography, the obvious features, the threats in plain sight.

What the ST does **not** do is read out a list of everything that will go wrong. The crew sees what's visible. What's hidden stays hidden until they find it — by casing the place, or the hard way.

This phase is roleplay. No rolls, no Alert. Just the job, and the crew deciding whether to take it. (They take it. Let them deliberate anyway.)

Phase 2 — Planning

Now the crew turns what they can see into a plan. Two things happen here: **Casing** and **Preparation**.

Casing — earning intel. The crew can dig for information they don't already have. Each spider may take one **Casing roll** — Perception or Tactics, or a relevant Perk or ability — and **each Success reveals one concrete piece of intel** the ST is holding: a threat and its rough patrol line, a locked square, a gap in a wall, a hazard, the type of lock on the case. Lookouts and their Perks shine here. What the crew doesn't uncover, they walk in not knowing. Intel is earned, not handed out — and it's *information*, not a free win. Knowing the cat's route doesn't beat the cat. It just means you're not surprised by it.

Preparation — setting up, not skipping ahead. The crew may also make a few concrete preparations on the known map. Each is tactical setup, not a guaranteed success:

- Choose your entry square, or split the crew across two entry points.
- Pre-place one Silk Line on a route you know.
- Stash one small item in a known square (see the Ghost's Dead Drop).
- Set a Contingency, a Shortcut, or a Trap, if a Perk grants one.

For **each Preparation**, the ST designs one complication — not one that cancels the prep, one that adds texture. The window is real, but the world is complicated, and preparation has limits.

Nothing in Planning auto-beats an obstacle — except the Lookout's Contingency Perk, which buys exactly one pre-arranged success. Planning buys you knowledge and position. What you do with them is the heist.

Phase 3 — The Heist (3–4 Obstacles)

The crew moves. The Alert starts at 0 and begins to climb. Between the entry and the objective stand **3–4 obstacles** — specific challenges, each with a clear goal, a success outcome, and a failure outcome.

Obstacles aren't scripted scenes. They're situations the crew solves however they like, on the grid, with the dice and the Alert handling the consequences. **At least one obstacle per heist should be something the crew didn't uncover in Planning** — the thing casing missed, or the thing that wasn't there yet.

Phase 4 — The Escape (1–2 Obstacles)

Objective or not, getting out is its own problem, and the Wheelman earns their keep. **The Alert carries over unchanged** — if the heist ended in Full Alert, the escape starts in Full Alert. That's the job.

Escape obstacles are leaner than heist obstacles — about pace and pressure. The goal is always the same: get out. The route is negotiable.

Crucially, **escape is not just an Athletics problem**. Every spider needs a way to contribute. The Face can talk a staffer into looking the wrong way. The Tinkerer can jam a door behind the crew. The Ghost can hold an exit open. The Grifter can pull all eyes to the wrong side of the building. The Wheelman knows the route — but everyone has a part in reaching it. This is a design requirement, not a nicety: at least one escape obstacle per heist must be solvable without Athletics. A low-BODY spider with nothing to do during the escape means the ST didn't build the escape right.

Phase 5 — The Debrief

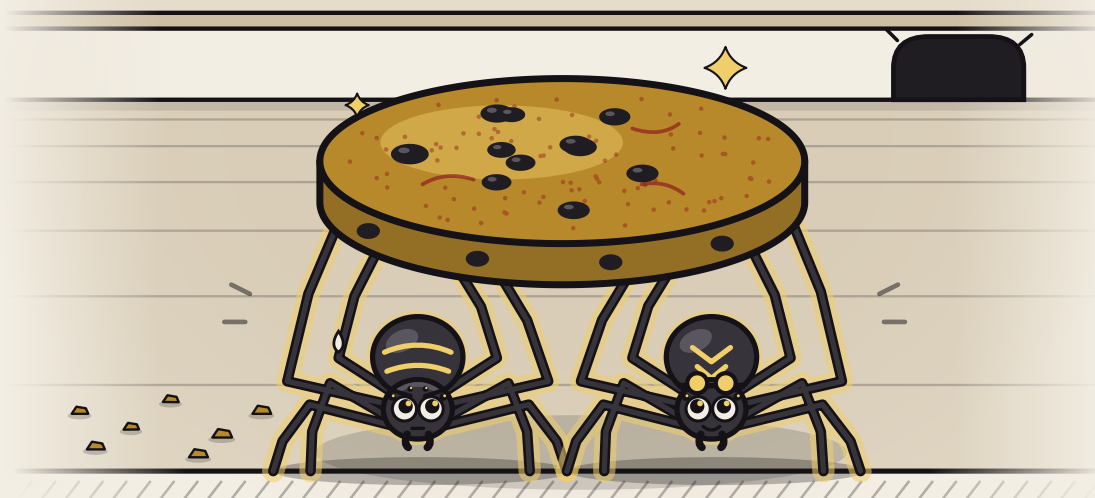
The crew is out and mostly alive. Count what they got.

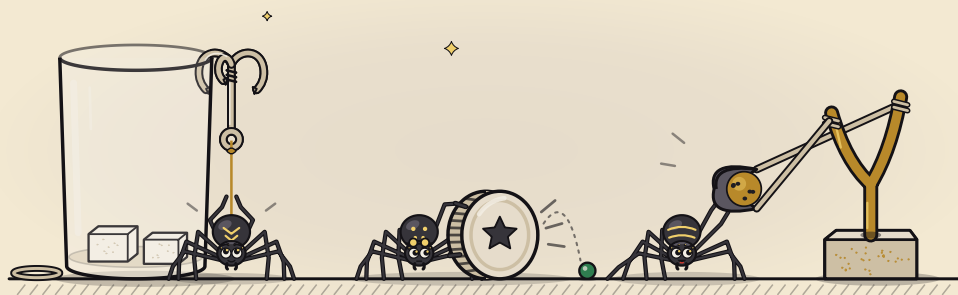
OUTCOME	ADVANCEMENT POINTS
Full Success	Escaped with the complete objective. Full AP for the difficulty: Easy 2, Standard 3, Hard 5, Absurd 6, Legendary 8.
Partial Success	Escaped alive but without the objective, or with incomplete loot. Half AP, rounded down.
Loss	The whole crew went Out before escaping. (Replacements arrive at the next obstacle, so a Loss means every spider is Out at the same time.) No AP. Significant embarrassment. Not discussed.

SPENDING AP

1 AP: +1 to a Skill · 2 AP: +1 to an Attribute · 3 AP: a new Perk from your Role list (no maximum). After creation, Skills and Attributes can reach 5 (Attributes include the species bonus); the creation cap of 3 no longer applies. You start every heist with WIT + NERVE Silk Points, using your current WIT and NERVE.

Win: escape with the objective. **Partial win:** escape without it, everybody lives. **Loss:** the entire crew goes Out before anyone gets clear. Loss is rare, and when it happens it's usually the funniest session the group has had.





CHAPTER 12

Silk, Gadgets & Found Materials

SPIDERS DON'T CARRY BRIEFCASES. THEY HAVE THREE things: silk, whatever's lying around the location, and a Tinkerer who can turn a bent paperclip into a grappling hook given forty minutes and no supervision.

Silk Is the Universal Tool

Every spider produces silk, and silk is always available. As your Action, roll GRACE + Acrobatics against Difficulty 2 (or spend **1 SP** to skip the roll) to run a **Silk Line** between two points up to **5 squares apart**. A Silk Line is safe footing the crew can climb or cross with no Acrobatics roll — up a wall, across a gap, along a ceiling — and it holds up to two spiders at once. It stays until it's broken or the scene ends.

Silk also does the small stuff without ceremony: anchoring yourself before a drop, tying off a light object to haul it, lowering a crewmate. If it's the kind of thing silk obviously does and there's no real risk, just do it.

Certain species and Roles push silk further — the Orb Weaver's webs (Chapter 4), the Bruiser's Silk Grapple, the Ghost's Silk Trail. Those are on their entries.

Found Materials

The location is full of things a spider can use — a bottle cap, a rubber band, a paperclip, a coin balanced on an edge. Any spider can try to repurpose a found object with a **WIT + Engineering** roll; the Difficulty scales with how ambitious the idea is. Turning a bottle cap into a shield is Easy. Turning three rubber bands and a thumbtack into a working latch-release is not.

The Tinkerer's "**I Made a Thing**" (Chapter 5) is the specialist version of this — faster, more reliable, and built for the moment you need a gadget *now*. Found materials are what everyone else uses when the Tinkerer is busy or in a jar.

The Loot

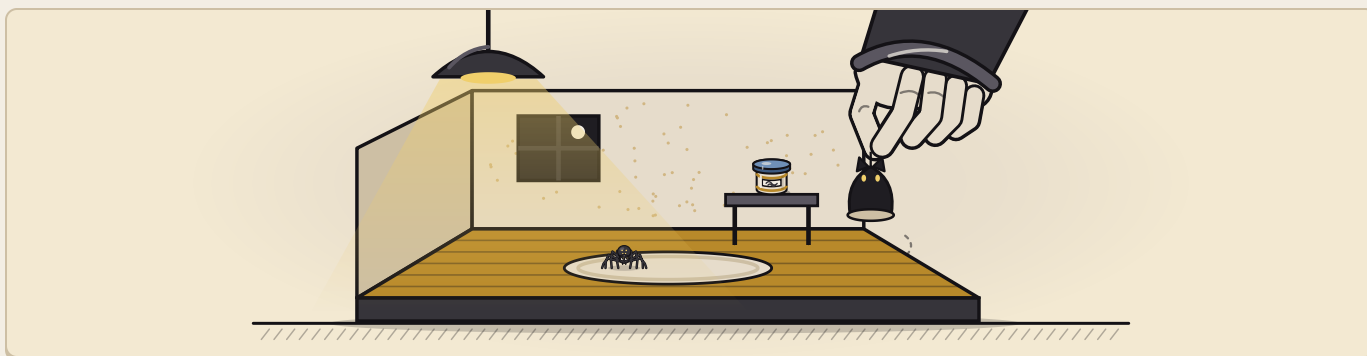
TIER	DESCRIPTION
Crumb (Easy)	A single bit of food, a small charm, a coin. Simple job, modest reward.
Trinket (Easy)	A small shiny thing, a memory stick, a piece of jewelry light enough to move.
Prize (Standard)	Something significant — the main event of a proper heist. Full reward on success.
Treasure (Hard or Absurd)	High value, high security, genuinely dangerous to take.
The Big Score (Legendary)	The kind of job spiders tell the spiderlings about. Maximum reward. Maximum everything-went-wrong.

PART TWO

The Storyteller's Guide

Everything you need to run the world. The crew will blame you for all of it. That's accurate.





CHAPTER 13

Running the Heist

RUNNING HEISTY SPIDEYS IS A LITTLE DIFFERENT from running most games, and the difference is worth getting straight up front.

You are not running a balanced encounter. You are not challenging the crew optimally, or protecting a plot, or keeping narrative control. You are running a **place** — a real location with real geography, threats that follow real routines, and at least one thing the crew didn't account for — and you are running it honestly. Make the location feel real, the stakes feel earned, and the failures land funny. The crew does the rest.

Three Ways to Run It Well

1. Be a fair world, not a fair opponent. The cat patrols on its actual route. The human wakes because there was actually a loud noise. The vacuum turns because vacuums turn. You're not trying to catch the crew — you're being the place they broke into. The place catches spiders on its own.

2. Make failure a door, not a wall. When the crew fails — and they will — turn it into a new situation, not a stop sign. The lock doesn't open *and* something shifts in the kitchen. "You failed, nothing happens, try again" is the least interesting outcome in any game. Every failure should hand the crew a new problem worth reacting to.

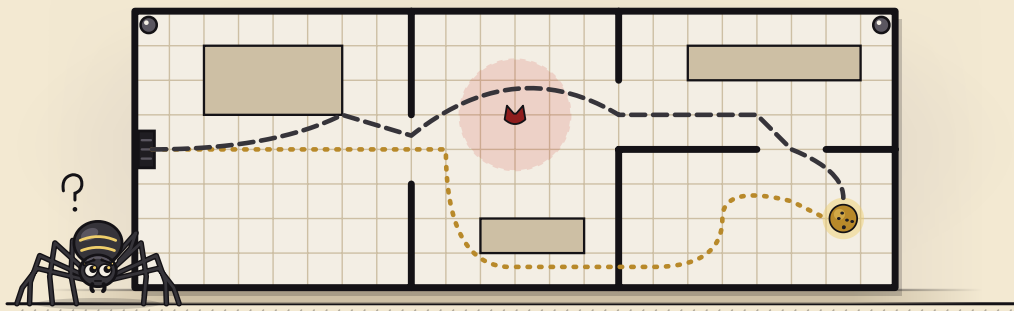
3. Say yes, then set a Difficulty. The crew will try things you didn't plan for. The Grifter will impersonate a receipt. The Bruiser will attempt to intimidate a vacuum. The Face will try to have a real conversation with a goldfish. Let them. Pick a Difficulty, roll, and find out what happens. "Yes, roll for it" is almost always a better answer than "no."

The Unknown Obstacle

Every heist should have at least one obstacle the crew didn't uncover in Planning — not an unfair trap, but something that emerges from the location and the rising Alert. It's not you ambushing them. It's the world being a world. Introduce it when it becomes unavoidable — when the crew reaches the relevant spot, when the Alert crosses a threshold that makes it inevitable, or simply when the timing is right. Don't foreshadow it in the Score. Let it arrive.

Pacing With the Alert

The Alert is your pacing tool. At low Alert, play the world calm. At mid Alert, foreshadow and put things in motion. At high Alert, escalate for real. At the Limit, don't just announce the heist is over — play the lockdown. The human hits the lights. The cat goes into full hunt. A second vacuum appears from somewhere. The crew scrambles for the exits. This is the best part of the night; treat it that way.



CHAPTER 14

Building a Heist Location

A GOOD LOCATION IS THREE THINGS: A CLEAR GRID THE crew can read, threats with real patterns, and at least two routes between any two points that matter.

Draw the Map

Build the location as a **gridded map** — squares the crew can count on. It doesn't need to be to scale or beautiful; it needs to be legible. A typical location is **4–6 connected areas**. A single room runs roughly **8–14 squares across**. For each area, note:

- **Walls and doors** — what blocks movement and line of sight, and where the gaps are.
- **Furniture and clutter** — what gives cover, what counts as rough ground, what a spider can climb or hide behind.
- **Entry points** — at least two ways in, ideally more.
- **The objective's square** — where the prize actually is.
- **One threat or hazard** that lives in that area.

Then place your **threat tokens** where they actually start, and give each a patrol line measured in squares. The crew is allowed to count the distance to the cat. Let them.

TWO ROUTES, ALWAYS

The single most important rule of location design: between any two significant points, there must be at least two viable routes. One over the counter, one along the baseboard. One through the vent, one under the door. A location with a single path isn't a heist — it's a corridor, and the crew is just waiting for the dice to fail. Give them choices and the location runs itself.

Active Threats

Every good location has things that move — the cat, the vacuum, the human up for water at 2 a.m., the guard spider. Each active threat should have:

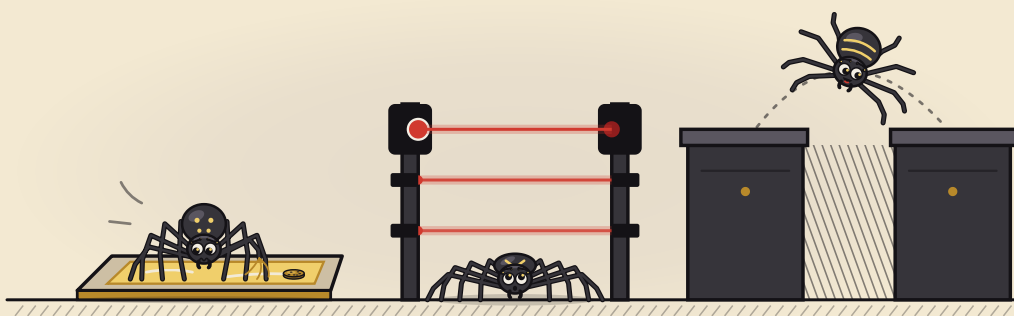
- A **patrol pattern or routine**, even an irregular one, mapped in squares.
- A **trigger** — what flips it from passive to active.
- An **Alert reaction** — what it does when the Alert hits certain thresholds.

PATROL EXAMPLE — HOUSE CAT

Route: asleep on the living-room couch ~70% of the time. When bored or hungry, walks a loop through the kitchen and hallway — about 12 squares, one lap every few rounds. Trigger: noise above a threshold (the Alert reaching 3) wakes it and makes it curious. Alert 3: opens its eyes, turns toward the sound. Alert 5: up and walking toward the noise. Alert 7: actively hunting. While it hunts, Stealth near it is at the Lockdown penalty like everything else.

Setting the Alert Limit

When you build the location, set its **Alert Limit** from the table in Chapter 9: Easy 10, Standard 8, Hard 6, Absurd 4, Legendary 2. **The Limit is the difficulty.** A lower Limit means the location tolerates less before it locks down — that's the whole knob. A first-time crew should start at Easy or Standard. A crew that cleared a kitchen and wants a pet store next is ready for Standard or Hard.



CHAPTER 15

The Obstacle Toolkit

AN OBSTACLE IS A SPECIFIC CHALLENGE BETWEEN THE crew and the objective — a clear goal, a success outcome, a failure outcome. Here's a working toolkit. Difficulties assume a calm location; the Alert raises them as it climbs.

Creature Obstacles

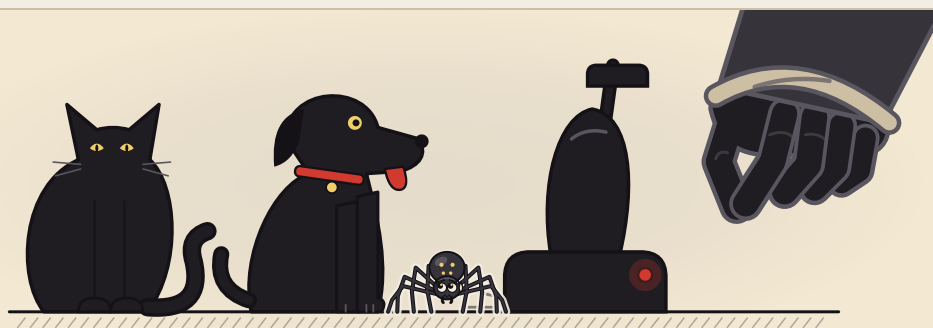
OBSTACLE	PRIMARY ROLL	NOTES
House Cat	Stealth or Persuasion (3)	A sleeping cat stays asleep. An awake one must be distracted, charmed (hard), routed around, or survived.
The Dog	Athletics or Deception (4)	Excellent nose. Distraction works well. Do not engage directly — the Bruiser especially.
The Goldfish	Persuasion (1)	Will cooperate. Has a three-second memory. Cannot actually help with anything.
Guard Spider	Brawl or Stealth (3)	Another spider, hired. Knows what you are and what you're doing.
Curious Child	Deception or Stealth (3)	Children look directly at things. Dangerous. Easily distracted by anything shiny (Difficulty 2).
The Exterminator	Any (4–5)	Came prepared. If the Alert got this high, something already went very wrong.

Environmental Obstacles

OBSTACLE	PRIMARY ROLL	NOTES
Vacuum	Athletics or Tactics (2)	Predictable but relentless. Know the route and it's avoidable. Fear of Vacuums applies.
Motion Sensor	Engineering or Stealth (3)	A beam across a line of squares. Don't cross it — or jam it (Engineering), or cross it very, very slowly.
Sticky Trap	Acrobatics or Perception (2)	A glue trap on the floor. Perception to spot it in time; Acrobatics if you didn't.
The Gap	Athletics or Acrobatics (2–4)	A distance too wide to step across. Difficulty scales with the number of squares and what's below.
Slippery Surface	Acrobatics (2)	Steel counters, glass, anything the human cleaned recently. Costs double movement or a roll.
Locked Drawer	Engineering (3)	It's locked. The Tinkerer's problem. Or the Bruiser's, which raises the Alert.

Human Obstacles

OBSTACLE	PRIMARY ROLL	NOTES
Sleeping Human	Stealth (2)	Asleep and fine — stay quiet. At Alert 5 they stir; at 7 they're up and turning on lights.
Distracted Human	Stealth (1)	On their phone, watching TV. Use the window. It closes.
Alert Human	Deception or Stealth (4)	Looking for something. Possibly for you. Do not get spotted.
Human With Broom	Athletics (3)	The broom has already swung once. Keep moving.



CHAPTER 16

Creature Compendium

E VERY MAJOR THREAT HAS A STAT BLOCK: WHAT IT rolls, how fast it moves in squares, how fast it escalates, and how to run it. When a creature acts

against the crew, roll the listed pool and count 4+; that's what the crew is up against.

House Cat

"The Reason We Can't Have Nice Heists"

THREAT LEVEL Standard **ALERT CONTRIBUTION** +1 per round while active **SPEED** 8

Perception 4 • Pursuit (Athletics) 5 • Pounce (Brawl) 4

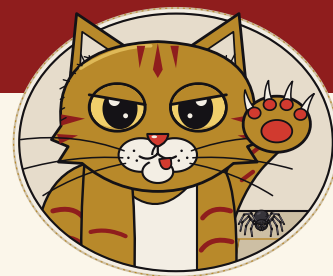
Passive: asleep ~70% of the time. When awake, paying complete attention.

Senses: spots suspicious movement within about 6 squares in line of sight.

Escalation: Alert 3, ears rotate. Alert 5, moves toward the sound. Alert 7, hunting.

Weakness: shiny objects (Difficulty 1 to redirect), sudden loud noises in the opposite direction, and cucumbers. The ST may rule a cucumber a Difficulty 0 distraction if the crew somehow produced one.

Fear: nothing. The cat fears nothing.



House Dog

"It Wants to Be Friends. That's Worse."

THREAT LEVEL High **ALERT CONTRIBUTION** +2 per round while active (it is loud) **SPEED** 8

Nose (Perception) 5 • Chase (Athletics) 4 • Bark (Intimidation) 5

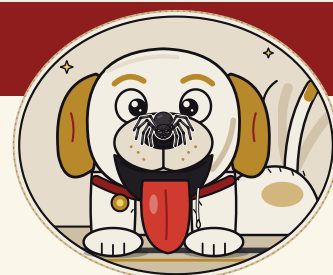
Passive: not malicious. Wants to play. Equally threatening.

Senses: smells a spider automatically at Alert 2+; doesn't need line of sight.

Escalation: at Alert 4 it barks. When it barks, the Alert immediately rises by 2.

Weakness: treats, another animal to fixate on, going outside (needs a door opened, which is a whole thing).

Note: the dog will try to carry crew members gently in its mouth. Acrobatics (Difficulty 4) to escape. It thinks it's helping.



Vacuum

"It Has No Feelings, and That Makes It Worse"

THREAT LEVEL Low-Medium **ALERT CONTRIBUTION** +1 per round in pursuit

SPEED 4 (slow, tireless)

Navigation 2 • Pursuit 3

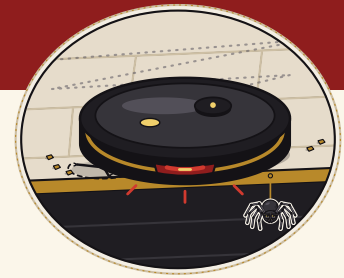
Passive: follows a programmed route. Predictable, loud, covers the same ground on a loop.

Senses: notices nothing. Navigates by bumping into things.

Weakness: furniture legs, small obstacles, and stairs (it stops at stairs and makes a sad noise).

Fear Interaction: any spider with Fear of Vacuums treats it as an active threat no matter what it's doing. The vacuum is unaware of this. The vacuum is unaware of everything.

Special: a spider that climbs onto the vacuum rides along with it. This is both tactically useful and deeply undignified.



Curious Child

"The Most Dangerous Predator in the Location"

THREAT LEVEL High **ALERT CONTRIBUTION** +3 if it catches a spider (pure excitement)

SPEED 6

Spotting 4 • Capture Attempt 3 • Shouting for a parent: automatic at Alert 7+

Passive: present during the day, actively hunting for interesting things to catch.

Senses: checks everywhere — under the couch, behind the shelf, directly into corners.

Weakness: television (Difficulty 1), toys (Difficulty 1), snacks (Difficulty 0).

Capture Result: a caught spider goes into a jar with air holes and is given a name. The Alert immediately rises by 3 (this replaces, not adds to, the usual +2 for a spider going Out), and the crew now has a second objective: get that spider back.



Guard Spider

"Professional. Unfortunately."

THREAT LEVEL High **ALERT CONTRIBUTION** +1 per round aware, +2 if it calls for backup

SPEED 6

Perception 4 • Brawl 3 • Stealth 2 • Deception 1

Passive: usually hired by someone who knew a heist was possible. Patrols actively.

Note: cannot be charmed by the Face — professional courtesies. Raises the Alert by 1 the moment it spots the crew.

Weakness: bribery (the crew must produce something valuable on the spot), the Grifter's Decoy (works once), the Bruiser (works, but loudly).

Note: guard spiders aren't evil. They're working. The crew could try talking to one. The Difficulty is 4. Worth one attempt.



Corn Snake

"Slow to Commit. Then Very Much Committed."

THREAT LEVEL Standard **ALERT CONTRIBUTION** +1 per round while active **SPEED** 4

Perception 3 • Strike (Brawl) 4

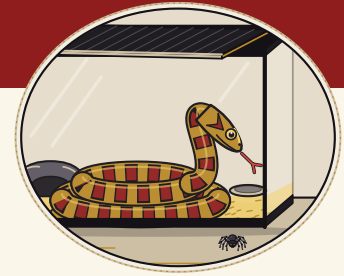
Passive: coiled in its display tank; the lid is loose.

Senses: notices movement within 3 squares of the tank.

Escalation: Alert 3, tongue flicks toward the crew. Alert 5, noses at the loose lid. Alert 7, out of the tank and hunting.

Weakness: a heat lamp to bask under, a lid that's actually shut.

Note: a Strike that lands drops a Vitality level like any hit.



Alert Parrot

"It Will Describe You. In Detail. At Volume."

THREAT LEVEL Standard **ALERT CONTRIBUTION** +1 each round it's repeating something

SPEED 0 (caged)

Perception 4 • Mimicry (Deception) 3

Passive: repeats what it hears, loudly and at length.

Senses: sees the whole front of the store from its cage.

Escalation: Alert 3, mutters. Alert 5, repeats every noise it hears. Alert 7, shrieks — the Alert rises by 2 once.

Weakness: a cloth over the cage, a cracker (Persuasion, Difficulty 1).



The Rat

"Runs Protection for the Block."

THREAT LEVEL Standard **ALERT CONTRIBUTION** none while the deal holds; +2 if it goes bad

SPEED 6

Perception 3 • Brawl 4 • Haggle (Persuasion) 4

Passive: lives under the dishwasher; nothing crosses the kitchen without his say-so.

Weakness: food, a favour owed, being treated like a professional.

Note: he wants something. Work out what. It's a negotiation, not a fight — until it is.



The Exterminator

"Came Prepared."

THREAT LEVEL High **ALERT CONTRIBUTION** +1 per round while on the map **SPEED** 6

Perception 5 • Spray (Athletics) 5

Passive: only appears once the Alert has reached Lockdown (7+), and only if the ST decides the humans called someone.

Senses: a flashlight and a professional's habit of checking corners.

Weakness: can't fit anywhere small; leaves once the job looks done.

Note: a Spray that lands drops a Vitality level; a spider caught in the open by one is Out.



Goldfish

"Will Cooperate. Cannot Help."

THREAT LEVEL None

ALERT CONTRIBUTION none

SPEED 3 (within its bowl)

Perception 1

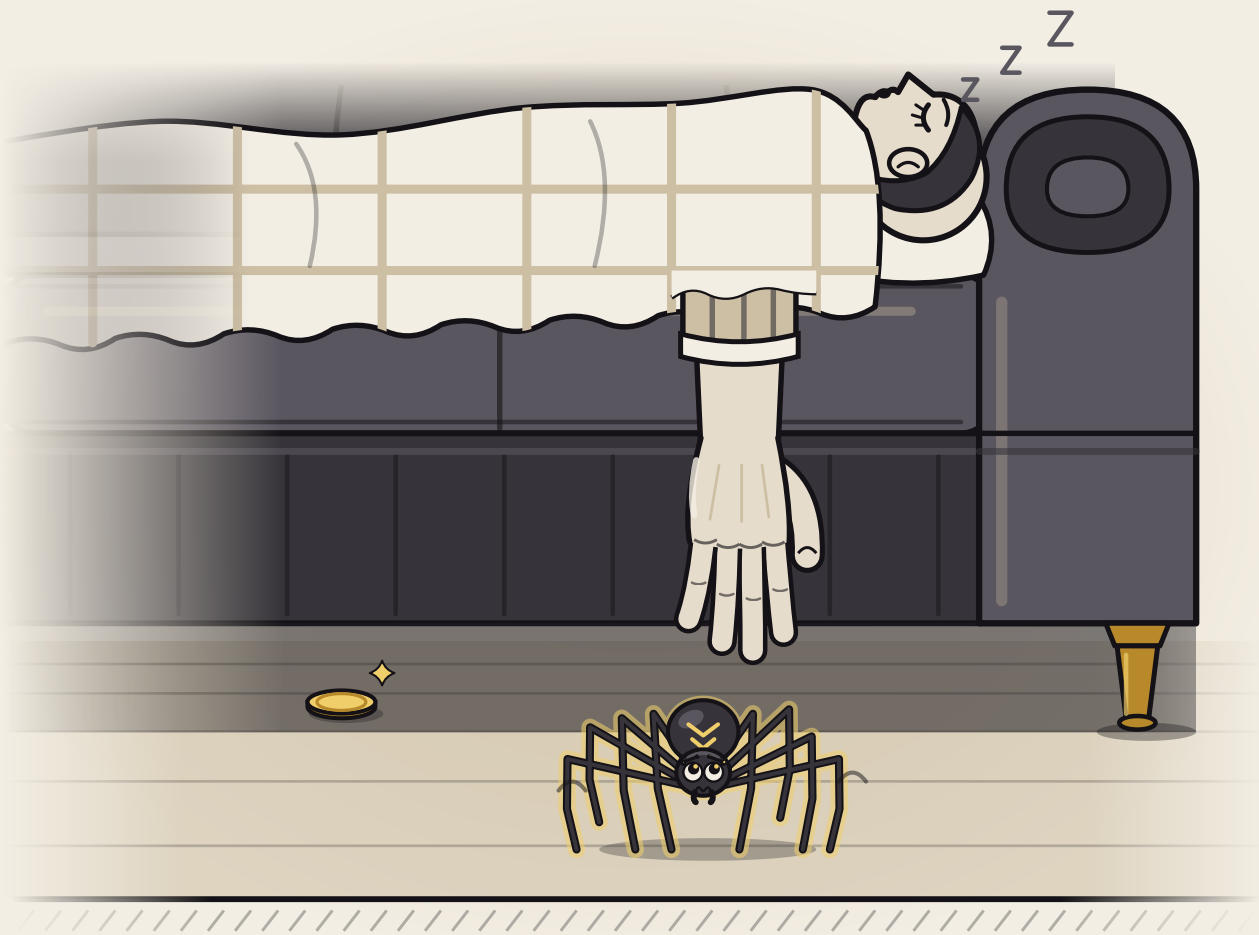
Passive: will cooperate with anything the crew asks. Has a three-second memory.

Weakness: none that matter.

Note: persuading it is Difficulty 1. It will agree. It will forget. It cannot actually help with anything.



Other threats in the ready-to-run heists use what's already here: the library cat is a House Cat; the librarian, restaurant staff and cleaning crew are Human Obstacles (Ch 15); a rival crew is built like the players' spiders.





CHAPTER 17

Running the Five Phases

Running the Score (Phase 1)

Set the scene. Put the map on the table and describe the location from a spider's eye — the geography, the obvious features, the objective, the threats in plain sight. Then stop. **Don't inventory the hidden dangers.** Let the crew ask questions, and answer honestly where a spider could reasonably know the answer. Decline where they couldn't. Ten to fifteen minutes; the crew will be itching to move.

Running Planning (Phase 2)

This is where the crew earns what they don't already know. When they take **Casing rolls**, have your hidden intel ready and hand out one true detail per Success — the cat's route, the type of lock, the loose vent, the hazard by the sink. Give them real information; it's not a trick. But hold the line between *knowing* and *winning* — casing tells the crew the cat naps until two; it doesn't make the cat sleep in.

As the crew makes **Preparations**, note each one and quietly assign it a complication — not one that cancels the prep, one that adds texture:

- “The cat's nap schedule is solid” — but the human fed it early today, so it wakes ten minutes ahead.
- “The tripwire is set” — but a stray candy wrapper is caught against it and will crackle the moment it's disturbed.
- “The window is our exit” — and it is. There's also a moth on the outside of the glass right now, and moths are dramatic.

The prep works. The world is just complicated.

Running the Heist (Phase 3)

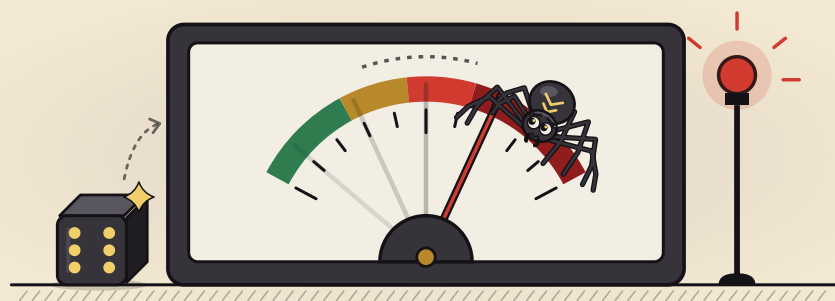
The crew moves across the map. **Update the Alert visibly every time it changes.** Describe each obstacle as the crew reaches it, give them a beat to decide their approach, then let them commit. When the Alert crosses a threshold, announce the change immediately — the moment it hits 5 and the cat gets up, say so. The crew adjusts, and that adjustment is the game.

Running the Escape (Phase 4)

Raise the energy. Keep it short and physical: “The cat's behind you and it's fast. The window is eight squares out. What do you do?” This is not the phase for long deliberation — it's silk, instinct, and fast decisions. And hold yourself to the rule: **at least one escape obstacle must be solvable without Athletics.** Frame obstacles with several answers — a staffer in the hallway invites Athletics (push past), Deception (talk through), Stealth (wait for the gap), or Acrobatics (over the shelf). If you've called for Athletics three times running, you've broken the rule. Reframe the next one.

Running the Debrief (Phase 5)

Let the crew breathe. Ask what they think went wrong. Let them argue. Award AP. Ask if anyone wants to describe what their spider does in the immediate aftermath. Then: “There's another job. Interested?” They're always interested.



CHAPTER 18

The Alert in Play

Keep It Visible

The Alert should be physically present — a shared number, a row of coins, a line on the whiteboard. The crew should see it at all times. When it moves, say so, out loud. Let them feel it climb.

Never Apologize for Raising It

When the Alert goes up, it goes up. Don't soften it. *"That failed — Alert goes to 6"* beats *"sorry, the Alert goes to 6."* The meter climbing isn't punishment; it's the world reacting to what the crew is doing. Be honest about it.

Describe the Thresholds

When the Alert crosses a threshold, describe the change instead of naming the number. Not *"the Alert hit 5"* — *"the cat opens its eyes. You can see it from here."* Same information, three times the weight.

The Limit Is a Moment, Not a Game-Over Screen

When the Alert hits the Limit mid-obstacle, finish the current action or round first, then bring down the lockdown — don't cut a player off mid-roll. The objective may be gone, but the crew isn't done. The escape is now a desperate sprint through a fully awake location. Play that. Give it weight. Make getting out feel earned.





CHAPTER 19

Five Ready-to-Run Heists

EACH HEIST IS READY TO RUN WITH MINIMAL PREP — A location, an objective, what the crew sees at the Score, and the intel the crew can uncover by casing. The threats and the unknown obstacle are **ST information**: present only what's visible, and let Planning reveal the rest.

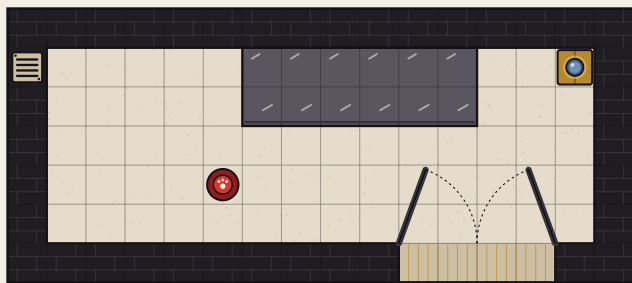
Heist 1 — The Cookie Situation

HOUSE · EASY

Alert Limit: 10 · **Loot:** Crumb/Trinket · **For:** a first session

The Objective: a specific cookie — the good kind, from the tin with the blue lid — in the kitchen of a single-story house. In and out. Except the cat is new.

What the crew sees at the Score: a standard two-bedroom home. The objective is a tin on the second shelf of the cabinet above the counter. In plain sight: a young cat, very interested in things, and a human who gets up for water during the night.



Sample map (one square ≈ one spider; # wall, . floor, C cabinet with the tin, ~ counter, K cat's bed, V entry vent)

Intel the crew can uncover (Casing): the counter was wiped down this evening and is slippery (Acrobatics to climb). The cat's bed is 9 squares from the cabinet. The human's water runs roughly every ninety minutes.

ST Prep — the unknown obstacle: there are two identical tins on that shelf. One holds cookies. One holds sewing supplies. The crew finds out which the hard way.

SUGGESTED OBSTACLES

1. Cross the living room while the cat is awake and watching the door.
2. Climb the cabinet — slippery surface, freshly wiped.
3. Open the tin quietly. Tight lid. The Tinkerer will have opinions.
4. (Unknown) It's the sewing tin. The cookies are in its twin, right beside it. Recalibrate.

Heist 2 — The Office After Hours

OFFICE · STANDARD

Alert Limit: 8 · **Loot:** Prize · **For:** a second or third session

The Objective: a memory stick in the desk drawer of the corner office. Empty after 6 p.m. except for a cleaning crew that comes through at 8.

What the crew sees at the Score: a small open-plan office with a corner room for the manager, two floors, entry from the ground-floor ventilation. In plain sight: a motion-sensor light system across the main floor, and a guard spider working the overnight shift.

Intel the crew can uncover (Casing): the sensor beam covers a known line of squares with a fixed timing gap. The guard spider's patrol loops the perimeter every few rounds. The drawer uses a standard lock.

ST Prep — the unknown obstacle: the cleaning crew came at 7 tonight, not 8. They're already here.

SUGGESTED OBSTACLES

1. The motion sensors. Pattern known, timing tight.
2. The guard spider. Professional, alert, doing the job. First real opposed roll.
3. The locked desk drawer. Engineering moment.
4. (Unknown) The cleaning cart is parked across the vent the crew planned to leave through.

Heist 3 — The Pet Store Problem

PET STORE • STANDARD

Alert Limit: 8 • **Loot:** Prize • **For:** any session that wants guaranteed disaster

The Objective: a specific cricket — yes, a cricket — in the feeder bin behind the service counter. A client is paying in premium silk. Don't ask.

What the crew sees at the Score: a three-aisle, single-floor retail space. In plain sight: a large corn snake in a display tank near the counter (its lid is loose, everyone knows, nobody has fixed it), and an alert parrot near the front that repeats what it hears, loudly and at length.

Intel the crew can uncover (Casing): the snake is slow to commit but fast once it does. The parrot's cage is 5 squares off the main aisle. The feeder bin sits behind the counter with one narrow approach.

ST Prep — the unknown obstacle: there are forty-seven crickets in that bin. The client described the target as "the big one." They are all the same size. This becomes a negotiation with a cricket.

SUGGESTED OBSTACLES

1. Enter through the loading dock — a gap in the back, but the feeder insects live there and some have opinions.
2. Cross the floor past the snake tank. The lid is loose. The snake is aware of you.
3. The parrot. It has seen you. It will describe you. In detail. At volume.
4. (Unknown) Forty-seven identical crickets. Identify the right one. It's a social encounter now.

Heist 4 — The Library Job

LIBRARY • HARD

Alert Limit: 6 • **Loot:** Treasure • **For:** an experienced crew

The Objective: a rare book in the locked reference section of a public library. It contains a spider map — a generational silk record of every web in the city. Someone wants it back. Someone else wants it more.

What the crew sees at the Score: three floors; the reference section is on the second, behind a locked glass case. In plain sight: a head librarian who stays late and is extraordinarily observant, and the library cat — enormous, and it has seen things.

Intel the crew can uncover (Casing): the librarian's route covers every floor on an irregular schedule. The case uses an antique lock (Engineering, Difficulty 4). There are two stairwells and a dumbwaiter between floors.

ST Prep — the unknown obstacle: another crew is already inside, after the same book.

SUGGESTED OBSTACLES

1. Entry — a guard spider (not hired, just lives here) near the entry point, with feelings about the reference section.
2. The librarian's late-night route. Every floor, irregular timing.
3. The locked case. Antique lock, Engineering Difficulty 4.
4. (Unknown) The other crew. Negotiate, compete, or recruit — all three are valid.

Heist 5 — The Restaurant Rush

RESTAURANT • HARD

Alert Limit: 6 • **Loot:** Prize • **For:** any session wanting maximum disaster

The Objective: the chef's personal recipe notebook, kept in the back office. A rival baker — a wasp, and nobody is happy about it — hired the crew. The place closes at 11; the crew moves at midnight. Except dinner service ran late.

What the crew sees at the Score: a mid-sized restaurant — kitchen, dining room, bar, small office. In plain sight: two closing staff finishing cleanup, and a kitchen that is still

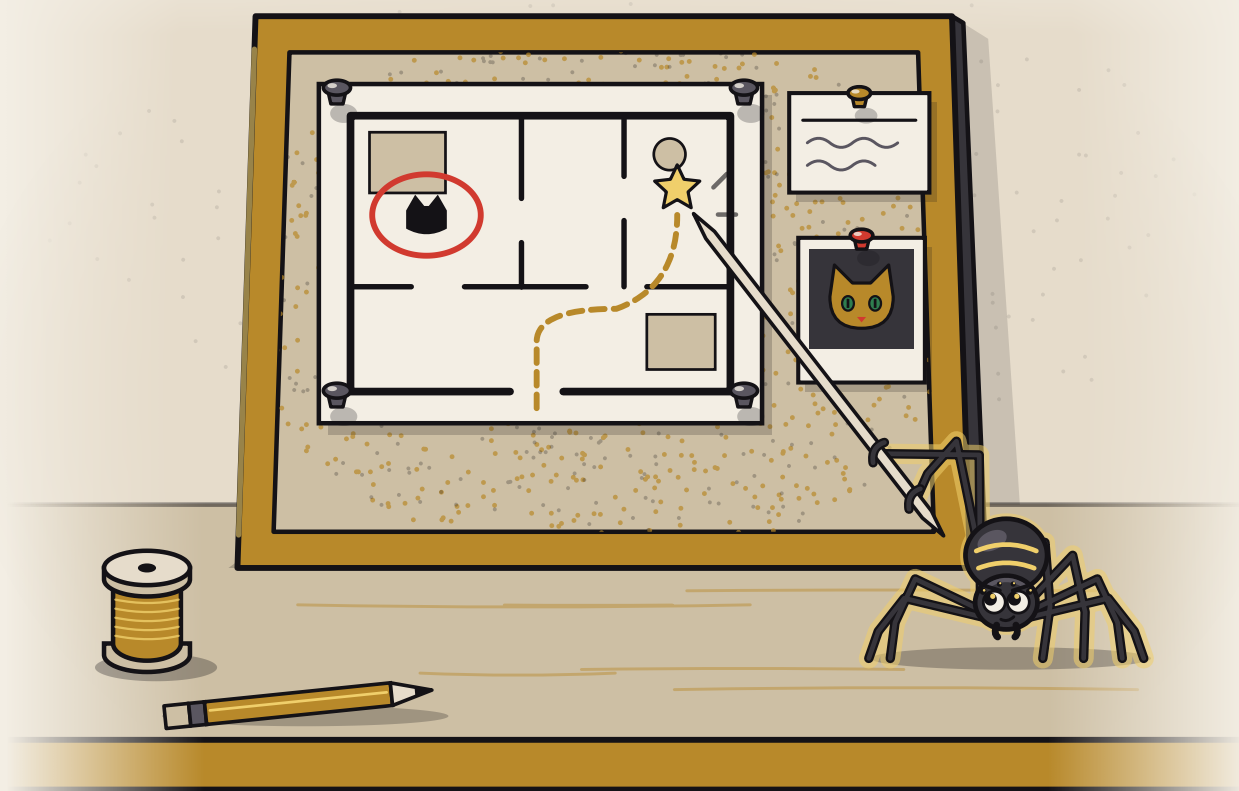
warm and smells extraordinary (a spider with Easily Distracted may have it triggered on entry).

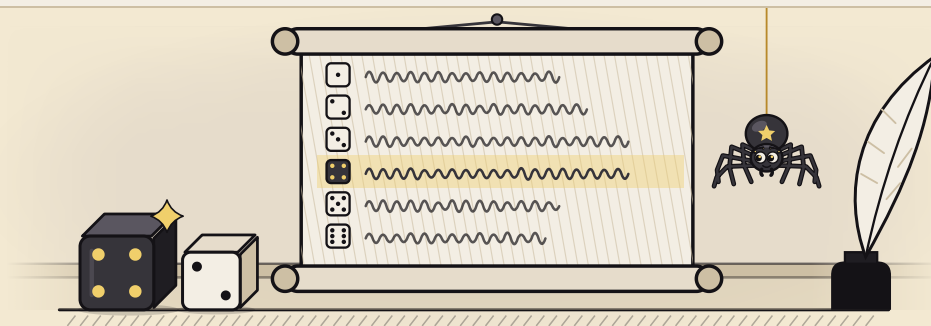
Intel the crew can uncover (Casing): the staff move unpredictably with no set route. A rat lives under the dishwasher and runs protection for the block — he'll want something. The office door sticks.

ST Prep — the unknown obstacle: a third staff member fell asleep in the break room and will wake at the worst moment.

SUGGESTED OBSTACLES

1. The dining room — two staff moving unpredictably, no patrol pattern.
2. The kitchen — warm, incredible smells. Easily Distracted triggers. Also, the rat.
3. The rat. Negotiations. He wants something. Work out what.
4. (Unknown) The sleeping staffer wakes exactly when the crew is in the office.





CHAPTER 20

Random Tables

ROLL WHEN YOU WANT THE UNIVERSE TO DECIDE. Play uses only d6s, but these creation tables use a d10 and a pair of d6s — this is character setup, not the heist.

Spider Name (Roll 2d6 — Gerald is rare, which is fitting)

ROLL	NAME	BACKGROUND
2	Gerald	A real spider. Has been through things. Don't ask about the incident.
3	Pebbles	Found near the front walk. Named after the first thing they saw.
4	Dusty	Lives in the dust. One with the dust. Is, arguably, mostly dust.
5	Crinkle	Makes a noise when they move. Nobody knows why, least of all them.
6	Jar Lid	Was trapped in a jar once. Has made peace with it. Jar Lid is fine.
7	The Architect	A self-given title. The crew uses it unironically because it fits.
8	Filament	Silk specialist. Particular about quality. Will discuss thread count.
9	Nook	Prefers corners. All corners. Any corner. A corner is home.
10	Cassette	Found in a box of old electronics. Has absorbed some energy from it.
11	Widow	Not a Black Widow. Just has a certain vibe. Nobody asks.
12	Eight	Simple. Honest. Eight legs, one name. What more do you want.

Species (Roll 1d6)

ROLL	SPECIES & VIBE
1	Jumping Spider — bold, visible, magnetic. Will jump at an inopportune moment.
2	Orb Weaver — methodical, architectural. Strong feelings about structure.
3	Wolf Spider — fast, physical, doesn't spin webs, considers this a personality.
4	Cellar Spider — thin and folding, fits through anything, already inside the wall.
5	Spitting Spider — precise, patient, excellent aim, almost never misses.
6	Crab Spider — sideways thinker, excellent at waiting, less good at stopping.

Role (Roll 1d6; on a 6, roll again)

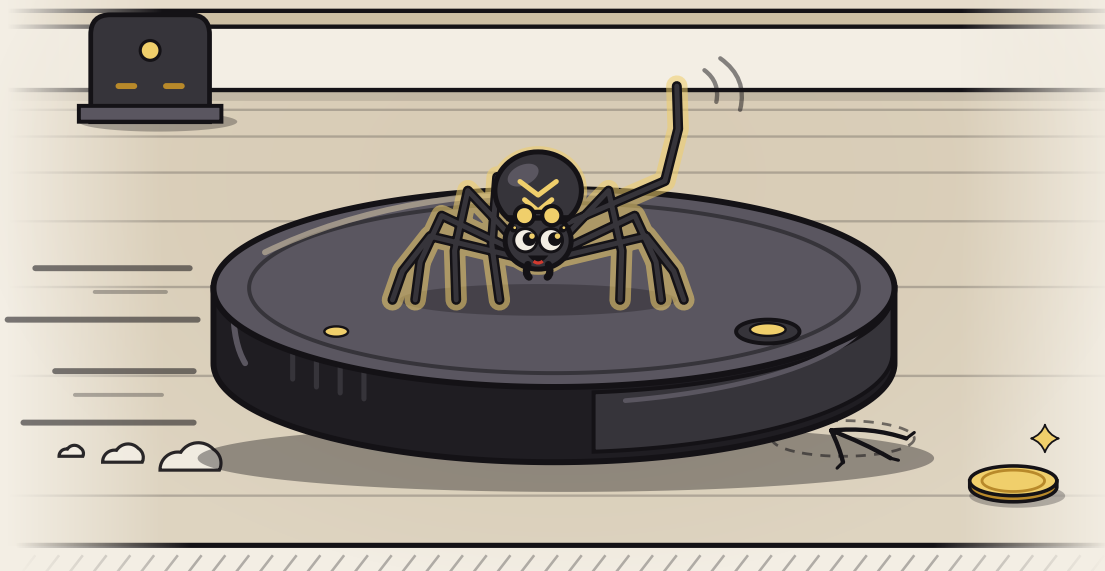
ROLL	ROLE & SUMMARY
1	The Face — you talk. To everyone. Especially the cat.
2	The Ghost — you disappear. Into walls, vents, the gap behind the fridge.
3	The Tinkerer — you build things out of other things. They mostly work.
4	The Bruiser — you solve problems physically. Plan B is also physical.
5	The Lookout — you watch, you notice, you warn the crew thirty seconds early.
6	Roll again: 1–3 Wheelman (you know every exit), 4–6 Grifter (nothing is what it seems, especially you).

Flaw (Roll 1d10)

ROLL	FLAW & NOTE
1	Arachnophobe Magnet — humans look at you more than other spiders. A documented phenomenon.
2	Overconfident — you've handled worse. (You haven't handled this.)
3	Loud — not physically loud. Operationally loud. Things break near you.
4	Dramatic — everything is an event. You know. You can't stop.
5	Allergic to Dust — you will sneeze at the worst moment, at least once.
6	Compulsive Planner — you must revise the plan, ideally right now, ideally out loud.
7	Butterfingers — you will drop the thing. The important thing. At the important moment.
8	Fear of Vacuums — vacuums cause immediate, total panic.
9	Easily Distracted — shiny objects and interesting smells derail you.
10	Show-Off — you'll take the flashier, harder approach. Sometimes it even works.

Mid-Heist Complication (Roll 1d6)

ROLL	COMPLICATION
1	The cat woke up. Not because of anything the crew did. Just because.
2	A drawer slid open on its own. Something's in it. Maybe the objective. Maybe not.
3	A human got up for water. They're in the kitchen. Right now. Everyone freeze.
4	The vacuum switched on. Its cycle begins. Fear of Vacuums triggers.
5	A phone lit up on the counter. The room is briefly, brightly visible.
6	Something fell off a shelf across the location. Not the crew's fault. The Alert rises by 1 anyway.





CHAPTER 21

Quick Reference

Rolling

TERM	RULE
Pool	Attribute + Skill (+ any bonus dice)
Success	Each die showing 4, 5, or 6
Difficulty	1 Trivial · 2 Easy · 3 Moderate · 4 Hard · 5 Absurd
Partial	1+ Successes but short of the target: succeed with a complication
Failure	0 Successes: fail, a consequence occurs
Critical	Double the required Successes: succeed + bonus + Alert -1 (Difficulty 2+ only)
Botch	Pool at 0 or below: roll 1 die. 1-3 fail + Alert +2. 4-6 clean fail.
Assist	Adjacent ally rolls Skill only (min 1, max 3 dice). Each Success = +1 die.

The Grid

RULE	DETAIL
Scale	1 square = 1 spider. Distances are counted in squares.
Speed	Squares per turn, set by species. Most 5 · Wolf 7 · Jumping 6 · Crab 4.
Your turn	Move up to Speed (may split) + one Action. Diagonals count as 1.
Adjacency	The 8 surrounding squares. Brawl and Assist need adjacency.
Cover	A solid object between you and a viewer: +2 Difficulty to spot/target you.
Climbing	Normal cost on walls/ceilings. Slick/hostile surfaces cost double or a roll.
Hurt/Critical	Hurt: Speed halved (round down) · Critical: moves only with a crewmate's help, at half their Speed.
Turn order	Only when timing is tight: crew acts (any order), then the ST's threats.

The Alert

RULE	DETAIL
Only goes up	+1 failed roll w/ consequence, spotted briefly, Silk Clutch · +2 Botch, confirmed alert, spider Out, Loud Failure · +X each round a creature is active (its stat block)
Thresholds	3-4 Stirring: Stealth +1 · 5-6 Active: threat wakes, no roll penalty · 7+ Lockdown: all rolls +1 (Stealth +2, stacks) · Limit: Full Alert
Reduction	Critical Success only (Difficulty 2+): Alert -1
Limits	Easy 10 · Standard 8 · Hard 6 · Absurd 4 · Legendary 2

Silk Points

COST/REWARD	EFFECT
1 SP	+1 die to a roll · run a Silk Line (≤5 squares)
2 SP	Reroll up to 3 dice · build a web structure · Improvise (swap in a plausible Skill, +1 Difficulty)
3 SP	Silk Clutch (fail → success, Alert +1) · Damage Control (crew: one spike of +2 or more -1, once/heist)
4 SP	Not Part of the Plan (negate one complication, once/heist)
Earn +1	Flaw bites · spectacular funny failure · creative species use
Earn +2	Genuinely brilliant plan, table agrees, ST confirms

Vitality

STATE	EFFECT
Unharmed	Full pool.
Rattled	-1 die on all rolls.
Hurt	-2 dice, half Speed.
Critical	-3 dice, must be assisted to move.
Out	Remove from heist. Alert +2. Activate the Waiting Web.
Taking a hit	Drop 1 level. Shrug off with BODY+Endurance vs the attack: meet/beat = no drop; lose by 3+ = drop 2. Ties to you.

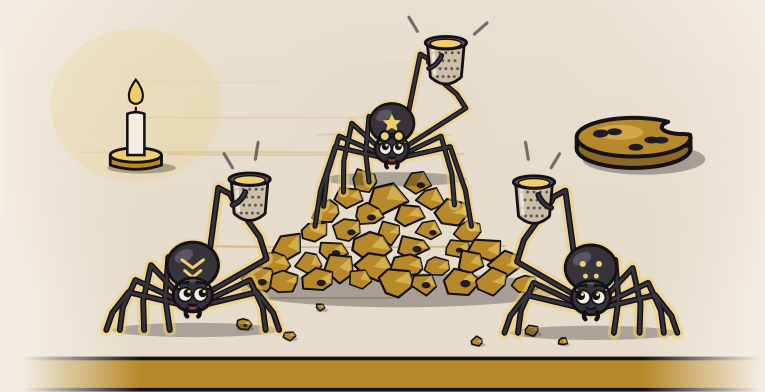
The Five Phases

PHASE	SUMMARY
1 — The Score	ST presents the job and the visible map. Roleplay only. No rolls, no Alert.
2 — Planning	Case for intel (a Success = one true detail). Make Preparations (setup, not auto-wins, except a Contingency; each gets a complication).
3 — The Heist	3–4 obstacles. The Alert climbs. At least one thing the crew didn't uncover.
4 — The Escape	1–2 obstacles. Alert carries over. At least one must be solvable without Athletics.
5 — Debrief	Count loot, award AP, argue about what happened, take the next job.

Advancement Points

RESULT	AP
Full Success	Easy 2 · Standard 3 · Hard 5 · Absurd 6 · Legendary 8
Partial	Half AP, rounded down
Loss	0 AP. Never discussed.
Spending AP	1 AP: +1 to a Skill · 2 AP: +1 to an Attribute · 3 AP: a new Perk from your Role list (no maximum). Skills and Attributes max 5 after creation.

Good luck out there. The cat is watching. Don't get vacuumed.



Character Sheet

Print one per player. Fill it in. Spill something on it. That's character.

Spider Name: _____

Species: Jumping / Orb Weaver / Wolf / Cellar / Spitting / Crab

Species Ability: _____ **Speed:** _____ squares

Crew Role: Face / Ghost / Tinkerer / Bruiser / Lookout / Wheelman / Grifter

Signature Move: _____

Perks (2): 1. _____ 2. _____

Flaw: _____

Attributes (10 pts · min 1 · max 5 including species bonus)

BODY	WIT	NERVE	GRACE

Skills (12 pts + 3 Role bonus · max 3 at creation)

ATHLETICS (B)	BRAWL (B)	ENDURANCE (B)	ENGINEERING (W)	PERCEPTION (W)	TACTICS (W)

STEALTH (N)	DECEPTION (N)	INTIMIDATION (N)	ACROBATICS (G)	PERSUASION (G)	DISGUISE (G)

Vitality: ☐ Unharm'd ☐ Rattled (-1) ☐ Hurt (-2) ☐ Critical (-3) ☐ Out

Starting Silk Points (WIT + NERVE): _____ **Current:** ○○○○○○○○○○

Tick your current Vitality. Cross off ○ tokens as you spend SP; add a tally mark if you earn one back. B = BODY · W = WIT · N = NERVE · G = GRACE

You are a spider.

You live in the walls of a building owned by creatures ten thousand times your size, who would respond to noticing you with anything from a startled noise to a rolled-up magazine. By any reasonable measure you are small and in danger.

You are also a criminal mastermind.

You have watched the humans for weeks. You know the schedule. You know where the good things are kept. You know the cat naps from two to four, and that the sensor in the hall has a blind spot exactly one spider wide. You have a crew. You have a plan. The plan is held together with silk and optimism, but it is a plan.

Tonight you run it. Something will go wrong — possibly everything. You will succeed anyway, or fail spectacularly, or, most likely, both, in a way the crew will discuss for the rest of your short and eventful careers.



For 2–6 players plus one Storyteller who volunteered. Ages 13 and up. The cat will not enjoy this game.

HEISTY SPIDEYS · FIRST EDITION